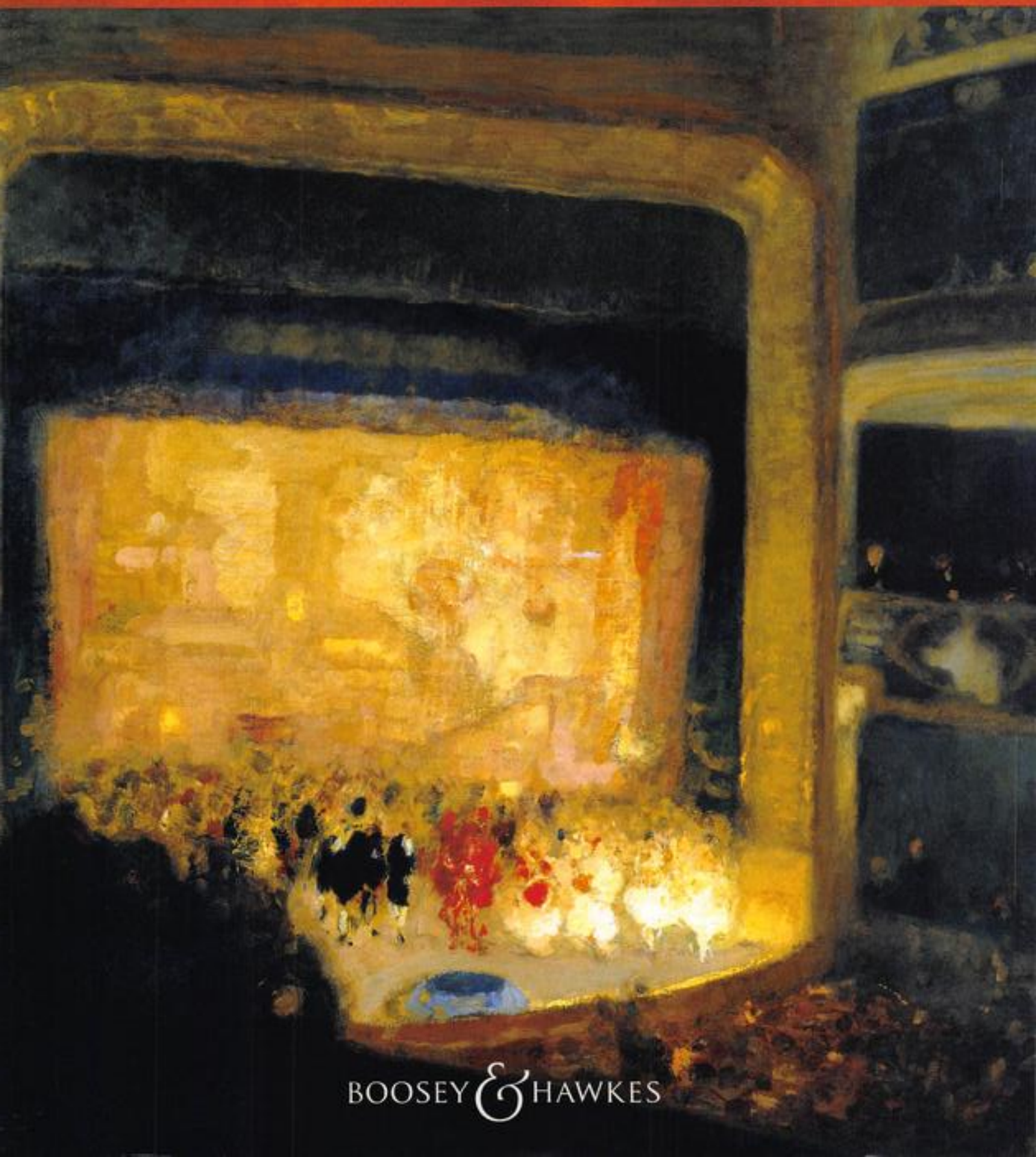
BARITONE / BASS

BOOSEY & HAWKES OPERA ANTHOLOGY



BOOSEY & HAWKES

EDITOR'S PREFACE

Boosey & Hawkes has been one of the leading publishers of opera for most of the last 100 years. The international constitution of the company, particularly with publishing in London and New York, has mined a vast amount of important British and American operatic literature, as well as the operas of Richard Strauss, Igor Stravinsky, Sergei Rachmaninoff, and Sergei Prokofiev. From this rich assortment of possibilities, practical choices have been made for this set of anthologies, which we hope will suit the needs of singers around the world.

Not all the selections are necessarily what one could call arias. Some composers of this and the previous century did not structure their operas with conventional arias. Role excerpts which are not actual arias can be very useful in auditions, and these have been selectively included. These excerpts by nature required editorial decisions regarding beginnings and endings.

Vocal notation differs in European and American practices. In conventional European practice, each syllable has its own beam, and if a syllable has more than one note, the notes are beamed together. Since the middle of the twentieth century, American music publishing has used instrumental style beaming instead. After much consideration, we have chosen to leave the vocal beaming as it was originally published, depending on the locale. This explains the mix of vocal notation within a volume.

Many of the selections have never been published outside the complete vocal score of an opera, making the *Boosey & Hawkes Opera Anthology* a uniquely valuable source. Some of this literature is well known around the world. But among the contents are many wonderful and intriguing pieces which are less often encountered. Besides opera auditions, a majority of the arias are rich material for recitals or concerts.

I would like to thank James Eggleston, Head of Publishing at Boosey & Hawkes, and Maggie Heskin, editorial director at Boosey & Hawkes, New York, for their valuable input. Thank you to Gayletha Nichols for her insightful advice. Without the significant help of assistant editors Joel Boyd, Brendan Fox and Joshua Parman these volumes certainly wouldn't exist, and I thank them heartily.

Richard Walters
May, 2018

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The year cited for each opera is the year of first performance. Some of the synopses have been adapted from those which were published on www.boosey.com, and from *American Arias*, edited by Philip Brunelle. Arias with texts in languages other than English are presented with English translations for study.

ALBERT HERRING

1947
music by Benjamin Britten
libretto by Eric Crozier, based on Guy de Maupassant's short story *Le Rosier de Madame Husson*
first performance: 20 June 1947, English Opera Group
setting: The small East Suffolk market town of Loxford, April and May, 1900

When the leaders of a small East Suffolk town cannot find a worthy virgin female candidate to conform to their strict Victorian ideals of morality to be May Queen, they settle instead on the inhibited, young and simple son of a shopkeeper, Albert Herring, who is declared May King, much to his mortified embarrassment. Albert disappears on the night of his coronation and is assumed murdered for the 25 sovereigns (each equal to £1) in his prize purse. The people who granted him the May King honor are shocked to find out that Albert is not dead after all, but has gone on a rebellious, drunken and disorderly night that ended in the gutter. For the first time in his life Albert stands up to his overbearing mother and is "better for his holiday."

The Vicar's Aria
(Virtue, says Holy Writ)

from Act I, scene 1
setting: The breakfast room in Lady Billows' house, Loxford.
character: The Vicar

The town committee is trying to choose a virtuous young woman to be appointed May Queen for the May Day festivities. After they realize that no eligible virgin candidates exist, Superintendent Budd suggests the grocer's son, Albert Herring, to instead be May King. Lady Billows asks the Vicar's advice.

Tickling a trout

from Act I, scene 2
Setting: Mrs. Herring's greengrocery shop.
character: Sid

Sid the butcher thinks Albert is too obedient to his mother, and tries to explain the male joys of activities like fishing and courting women.

Churchyard's agog with a crowd of folk

from Act II, scene 1
Setting: The interior of a marquee set up in the Vicarage garden.
character: Sid

Sid breathlessly tells Nancy about a May Day church service in which the Vicar preached on chastity, and during which Albert the May King was "on tenterhooks."

АЛЕКО
(ALEKO)

1893
music by Sergei Rachmaninoff
libretto by Vladimir J. Nemirovich-Danchenko
after Alexander Pushkin's poem 'The Gypsies'
first performance: 27 April 1893, Bolshoi Opera
setting: A camp of gypsies

A band of gypsies has pitched its tents for the night on the bank of a river. Beneath a pale moon, they light campfires, prepare a meal and sing of the freedom of their nomadic existence. An old gypsy tells a story. Long ago, he loved Mariula who deserted him for another man, leaving behind Zemfira, their daughter. Zemfira is now grown up, has her own child, and lives with Aleko, a Russian who has abandoned civilization for the gypsy life. Hearing this story, Aleko is outraged that Zemfira's father took no revenge on Mariula. But Zemfira disagrees. For her, as for her mother, love is free, and she herself has already tired of Aleko's possessiveness and now loves a younger gypsy, one of her own people. After dances for the women and the men, the gypsies settle down to sleep. Zemfira appears with her young lover, whom she kisses passionately before disappearing into her own tent to look after her child. Aleko enters and Zemfira taunts him, singing about her wild lover. As dawn comes, he surprises Zemfira and her lover together. In a torment of jealousy Aleko kills them both. All the gypsies gather, disturbed by the noise and discover the murders. Led by Zemfira's father, they spare Aleko's life but banish him from the band forever.

Каватина Алеко
(Aleko's Cavatina)

Scene 10
character: Aleko

The moon rises and begins to pale. After seeing Zemfira with her lover, Aleko broods on the catastrophe of his relationship with her, and the failure of his attempt to flee the ordinary world.

Весь табор спит.	*The whole Gypsy camp sleeps.*
Луна над ним	*The moon above it*
полночной красотою блещет.	*with midnight's beauty shines.*
Что ж сердце бедное трепещет?	*Why then is the poor heart trembling?*
Какою грустью я томим?	*With what sadness am I tormented?*
Я без забот, без сожаленья	*Without cares, without regret*
веду кочующие дни.	*I lead a nomad's life.*
Презрев оковы просвещенья,	*Having cast off the chains of enlightenment,*
я волен так же, как они.	*I am as free as they are.*
Я жил, не признавая власти	*I lived without recognizing the authority*
судьбы коварной и слепой.	*of a treacherous and blind fate.*
Но, боже, как играют страсти	*But, God, how the passions play*
моей послушною душой!...	*with my obedient soul!...*
Земфира!	*Zemfira!*
Как она любила!	*How she loved!*
Как, нежно приклонясь ко мне,	*How, tenderly leaning against me,*
в пустынной тишине	*in desolate silence*
часы ночные проводила!	*the nocturnal hours would spend!*
Как часто милым лепетаньем,	*How often with her lovely chattering*
упоительным лобзаньем,	*and intoxicating kisses*
задумчивость мою	*she could disperse*
в минуту разогнать умела!	*my pensiveness in an instant!*
Я помню: с негой, полной страсти,	*I remember: with languor, full of passion,*
шептала мне она тогда:	*she whispered to me then:*
"Люблю тебя! В твоей я власти!	*"I love you! I am in your power!*
Твоя, Алеко, навсегда!"	*Yours, Aleko, forever!"*
И всё тогда я забывал,	*And I would forget everything then,*
когда речам её внимал и,	*when I listened to her words,*
как безумный, целовал	*and like a madman kissed*
её чарующие очи,	*her enchanting eyes,*
кос чудных прядь, темнее ночи,	*the strands of her lovely braids, darker than night,*
уста Земфиры...	*and the lips of Zemfira...*
А она, вся негой, страстью полна,	*And she, full of bliss and passion,*
прильнув ко мне, в глаза глядела...	*leaning toward me, gazed into my eyes...*
И что ж? Земфира неверна!	*But what happened? Zemfira is unfaithful!*
Моя Земфира охладела!	*My Zemfira has grown cold!*

ARABELLA

1933
music by Richard Strauss
libretto by Hugo von Hofmannsthal
first performance: 1 July 1933, Dresden State Opera
setting: Vienna, 1860

The impoverished Count and Countess Waldner seek a rich suitor for their eldest daughter, Arabella, and have raised their younger daughter Zdenka as a boy to save expenses. Zdenka is in love with Matteo, who loves Arabella. The Count has written to a wealthy Croatian friend, enclosing a photo of Arabella, seeking a loan and a husband for his daughter. The friend's nephew and heir, Mandryka, is bewitched by the portrait and comes to Vienna to woo Arabella. At the Coachman's Ball, Arabella and Mandryka are attracted to each other. He describes a village custom in which a glass of water is offered by a maiden to her betrothed to drink. Arabella agrees to marry him but begs for a few hours to bid farewell to her former suitors. Zdenka arranges a meeting with Matteo, who believes he is meeting Arabella. This is overheard by Mandryka, who notes Arabella's departure and falls into a drunken fury at what he perceives to be Arabella's infidelity. The Waldners leave the ball and the Count commands Mandryka to follow. Back at the hotel, Matteo thinks he has met with Arabella in her darkened bedroom, but in the foyer Arabella is baffled by his allusions. In the growing confusion a jealous Mandryka challenges Matteo to a fight. Zdenka appears in a nightdress, revealing not only that he is really a she, but that she was the person Matteo found in Arabella's bedroom. Zdenka confesses her love for Matteo, who turns his affections away from Arabella and toward Zdenka. Arabella seeks forgiveness from Mandryka and asks her father to bless the union of Zdenka and Matteo. Mandryka, alone, contemplates his feelings for Arabella and sends a glass of water to her room. She brings it down for him to drink, an enactment of the village custom Mandryka related earlier, as a symbol of their love.

Nimmst einen Fiaker

from Act II
setting: A ballroom
character: Mandryka

Mandryka is elated that Arabella has agreed to marry him. He orders a servant, Djura, to wake up all the florists and flower vendors and bring flowers so that Arabella can dance on a floral cushion.

Nimmst einen Fiaker und noch einen zweiten;	*Go get a carriage, and then, get another,*
aufsperren lass dir die Gärtnergeschäfte,	*ask to unlock the florists' shops,*
aufwecken die hübschen Verkäuferinnen,	*wake up all those pretty flower girls,*
ausräumen solln sie ihre Keller!	*let them clean out all their cellars!*
Füllst einen Wagen an mit Rosen,	*One of the carriages fill with roses,*
einen mit roten und weißen Kamelien.	*and the other one with red and white camellias.*
Walzer soll sie auf Blumen tanzen,	*She will waltz on flowers,*
Abschied nehmen von Mädchenzeiten!	*pay farewell to the time of her girlhood!*
Später breit' ich meine Hände,	*Later I will spread my hands out,*
sie wird nicht mehr Walzer tanzen,	*and she will not dance waltzes any longer*
aber tanzen auf meinen Händen!	*but dance on my hands!*

Sie gibt mir keinen Blick

from Act III
setting: A lobby in the hotel
character: Mandryka

Since Arabella agreed to marry him, Mandryka's emotions have gone from elation to confusion. He overhears something he believes means she is unfaithful to him. He reacts to a note she wrote him with jealousy and disappointment, though he tries to show a happy face.

Sie gibt mir keinen Blick,	*She has no glance for me,*
sie sagt nicht gute Nacht,	*she does not say "goodnight",*
sie lässt mich stehn	*she leaves me here*
und geht.	*and goes.*
Hab' ich	*But then,*
was anderes verdient?	*What else do I deserve?*
Was ist verdient	*What is deserved*
auf dieser Welt?	*in all this world?*
Verdient ist nichts.	*Deserved…is nothing,*
Stockprügel	a *good thrashing*
sind verdient	*is deserved*
für einen Kerl wie mich –	*by such a lout as me –*
aber geschenkt hätt'	*Yet, as a gift*
ich gerne einen	*I'd have gladly taken*
Blick genommen –	*just one glance –*
so einen halben Blick!	*or even half a glance!*
Sie hat garnichts gemeint,	*She meant nothing at all,*
als ein Glas Wasser haben	*only a glass of water,*
und Ruh vor meinem Anblick.	*and then, no longer see me!*
Oder spotten hat sie wollen!	*Or perhaps, she meant to mock me?*
Vielleicht –?	*Perhaps – ?*
Wenn sie nur spottet, wenigstens,	*But if she just mocks me,*
ist's doch schon	*that alone…is…*
eine Gnade,	*a mercy she grants me,*
eine unverdiente,	*and an undeserved one,*
das weiß Gott!	*God knows!*

ARIADNE AUF NAXOS

1912, revised 1916
music by Richard Strauss
libretto by Hugo von Hofmannsthal
1912 version: opera in one act to be performed after Hofmannsthal's adaptation of Molière's play *Le Bourgeois gentilhomme*
first performance of the 1912 version: 25 October 1912, Hoftheater Stuttgart, Stuttgart State Opera
1916 revised version: opera in one act with a prologue
first performance of the 1916 version: 4 October 1916, Vienna State Opera
setting: Vienna in the early 18th century

Plot of the Revised Version

The Prologue

The richest man in Vienna has ordered a post-dinner entertainment for his guests. The Music Master complains that the new serious opera *Ariadne auf Naxos* is to be followed by a comedy performed by a burlesque group led by Zerbinetta. The Major Domo replies that his master has paid for what he wants. The young opera composer arrives, along with the two performing companies, and is made to feel distinctly unwanted. He is shocked to discover that Zerbinetta and the comedians are to perform after the premiere of his serious opera, and the Prima Donna objects to the rival female star. The Major Domo announces dinner has ended and that both opera and comedy must be played simultaneously so that the fireworks can begin at 9:00 p.m. The opera artists are horrified, but the comedians are happy to employ their improvisational skills. Zerbinetta is told the serious opera's plot and devises a synopsis for the combined entertainment. She charms the composer. He passionately agrees on the compromise, though soon after is in despair at realizing what he has agreed to do.

The Opera

Three nymphs sing of the sadness of Ariadne, abandoned by Theseus, as she bemoans her fate. Zerbinetta, with the comedians in the wings, suggests that Harlequin should sing a cheerful song. Taking no notice, Ariadne calls for Hermes, the messenger of death. The male comedians attempt to divert her, but Zerbinetta sends them off-stage and confides with Ariadne about the plight of all women at the hands of faithless men, while declaring women should be just as fickle in love. Ariadne retreats into her cave and the comedians' entertainment begins, with Harlequin winning Zerbinetta's affections. The three nymphs herald the arrival of Bacchus, who has escaped the lures of the sorceress Circe. Ariadne believes him to be Hermes and offers herself to him. Zerbinetta, in the wings, repeats her prediction: "a new god approaches and we surrender without a word," while Ariadne and Bacchus declare undying love.

Lieben, Hossen, Hoffen, Zagen

from The Opera
setting: The Island of Naxos
character: Harlekin (Harlequin)

Ariadne longs for death since Theseus has abandoned her. Zerbinetta urges Harlekin to cheer her up with a song.

Lieben, Hassen, Hoffen, Zagen,	*Loving, hating, hoping, doubting,*
alle Lust und alle Qual,	*all of joy and all of pain,*
alles kann ein Herz ertragen,	*all these things a heart can bear,*
einmal um das andre Mal.	*over and over again.*
Aber weder Lust noch Schmerzen,	*But neither joy nor sorrows,*
abgestorben auch der Pein,	*nor even pains,*
das ist tötlich deinem Herzen,	*that is fatal for your heart,*
und so musst du mir nicht sein!	*and I shall not have you that way!*
Musst dich aus dem Dunkel heben,	*From the darkness you must rise,*
wär es auch um neue Qual!	*even if to endure new pain,*
Leben musst du, liebes Leben,	*you must live, dear life,*
leben noch dies eine Mal.	*live just one more time!*

THE ASPERN PAPERS

1988
music by Dominick Argento
libretto by the composer based on the Henry James novella
first performance: 19 November 1988, The Dallas Opera
setting: A villa situated near the northern end of Lake Como, alternately during the summers of 1835 and 1895

Juliana Bordereau is a former singer and mistress of a deceased composer, Jeffrey Aspern. She is living with her niece Tina in a house on the edge of Lake Como. A stranger (the Lodger) visits them and asks to rent a room; he is a scholar of Jeffrey Aspern's work and hopes to find a supposed rare opera manuscript, based on Medea from Greek myth, that Juliana might possess. The opera scenes alternate between two time periods: 1885, when the Lodger arrives at Juliana's villa, and 1835, when a young Juliana discovers Aspern's relationship with another soprano. Near the end of the 1885 narrative, Juliana dies and Tina implies that the Lodger can have the *Medea* score if he marries her. The Lodger rejects her and decides to leave the next day. In the morning he tells her he has changed his mind, but now she declines, saying it is too late. After he leaves, Tina drops the score of the opera, page by page, into a fire.

What a yielding nature she has

from Act I, scene 5
setting: the music room.
character: Lodger

After a night out with Tina, the Lodger is surprised at how she seems so eager to please anyone who is kind to her. He thinks this may be a result of her introverted spinster life in the seclusion of the lake house.

THE BEGGAR'S OPERA

1948
realization by Benjamin Britten, from the original airs of John Gay's ballad opera (1728)
words by John Gay
first performance: 24 May 1948, English Opera Group
setting: London, early 18th century

Peachum, who knowingly buys stolen property for resale from thieves, discovers that his daughter Polly has secretly married Captain Macheath, a notorious highwayman and Peachum's main client. Peachum and his wife decide to kill Macheath for his money. At a tavern among prostitutes and thieves, Jenny Diver is hired by Peachum to capture Macheath, who is sent to Newgate Prison, run by the corrupt Lockit. Macheath plays on the heart of his former lover Lucy Lockit, the jailor's daughter. He denies being married to Polly and promises to marry Lucy, who cannot persuade her father to release Macheath. Lockit plans to profit from a deal with Peachum concerning Macheath's execution. Polly arrives, and Lucy and Polly are instantly in competitive conflict over Macheath's affections. Lucy connives to release Macheath, who escapes. He is recaptured and faces hanging. Rather than a moral end to the story, with the immoral Macheath's hanging, the Beggar (the narrator) urges the crowd to demand a reprieve and a happy ending is celebrated.

Thus gamesters united in friendship

from Act III, No. 39. Scene: Newgate
character: Lockit

Aware that Peachum has a plot, Lockit resolves to trick the details out of him and turn the affair to his own advantage. Lockit's song states that there is no honor among thieves.

BILLY BUDD

1951 (Original version in four acts), revised 1960 (Revised version in two acts)
music by Benjamin Britten
libretto by E.M. Forster and Eric Crozier, adapted from the story by Herman Melville
first performance of Original 4-Act version: 1 December 1951, Royal Opera Covent Garden
first performance of Revised 2-Act version: 9 January 1964, Royal Opera Covent Garden
setting: On board HMS *Indomitable* during the French Wars of 1797

The opera is preceded by a prologue in which the retired Captain Vere, an old man, ponders the significance of events that took place long ago. The main action is set on board the British naval vessel HMS *Indomitable* in 1797. The crew goes about its tasks driven by the brutality of the ships Master-at-arms, John Claggart, who rules by physical and mental domination. Three new sailors, press-ganged from a passing merchant ship, are brought on board. Two of them are reluctant and unpromising specimens, but the third, Billy Budd, is eager, young, strong and handsome. His goodness wins the hearts of all except Claggart, whose dark world is turned upside down by Billy's beauty and grace, and who determines to destroy him. To this end, Claggart manipulates Squeak to rifle amongst Billy's belongings, and when the young sailor catches him the old sea dog Dansker warns Billy that Claggart has it in for him. Claggart then has the Novice—cowed into submission by an earlier beating—try to bribe Billy into supporting mutiny, but to no avail. Nevertheless, Claggart takes the unsubstantiated complaint to Vere, though is interrupted in his accusation by a brief skirmish with a French frigate that ends with the enemy escaping. Claggart then accuses Billy, who is called in by Vere to defend himself. Billy's shock and stammer silences him. In anger at the outrageous, trumped-up charge, the innocent Billy knocks Claggart down with a single blow that strikes him dead. The law of the sea dictates that striking an officer requires death as punishment. The conflicted Vere decides he cannot save Billy, who is condemned. He goes to his death a loyal seaman, saying from the plank, "Starry Vere, God bless you!" In the Epilogue, we return to the aged Vere, who again ruminates over the moral conflict in his role in these events.

Billy Budd, king of the birds!

from Act I, scene
setting: The deck of HMS *Indomitable*
character: Billy Budd

Three sailors have been pressed into the Royal Navy, including Billy Budd. Even though he is young (he doesn't know his age), he is an experienced seaman, and is assigned to be foretopman. He is thrilled and exuberantly sings of his love for the sea and life on a ship. When he sings farewell to the *Rights o' Man*, his former ship, the men are stirred up, and the officers, confused and alarmed, clear the decks.

Billy's Farewell
Look! Through the port comes the moonshine astray!

from Act II, scene 3
setting: A bay of the gun deck
character: Billy Budd

Billy sits in his cell, awaiting execution. Dansker comes to see Billy to comfort him and to say goodbye. After Dansker leaves Billy sings his own farewells and resolves to stay strong through his inevitable hanging in the morning.

Claggart's Aria
O beauty, o handsomeness, goodness

from Act I, scene 3. The berthdeck.
character: Claggart

Claggart broods alone. He feels threatened by Billy's presence as a good, wholesome individual. Claggart has found a sense of order in his life of darkness and depravity, and feels that he has no choice but to destroy Billy at any cost.

CASANOVA'S HOMECOMING

1985
music by Dominick Argento
libretto by Dominick Argento, based on *L'histoire de ma vie* by Giacomo Casanova
first performance: 12 April 1985, Minnesota Opera
setting: Venice, the first week of Carnival Season, 1774

A hoax is played on the notorious Giacomo Casanova when the 49-year-old lover escapes prison to return to Venice during Carnival, after 18 years in exile. The whole town is delighted to learn that he has been trapped into seducing an opera singer whom the public knows as Bellino, a castrato in female dress. However, as Casanova comes to know Bellino, he realizes that the singer is actually a female singer named Teresa masquerading as a male castrato to promote her own opera career. Casanova then proceeds to turn the hoax to his advantage. He enlists the help of Teresa in fooling Madame d'Urfé, a wealthy and eccentric practitioner of the occult, whose greatest desire is to be reborn as a male. Using his made-up renown as a sorcerer, Casanova swindles the old lady out of her money and she dies as a result of the scheme. Casanova's cleverness, along with his reputation, helps him to elude the suspicious city authorities.

You have already heard one sermon tonight

from Act III, scene 3
setting: Piazza San Marco.
character: Casanova

After Barbara's wedding, Casanova, leads the party in a toast to the bride and groom and then sings his final air, which sums up the credo of his life, and of the opera: to live, to love, and to love living.

COLD SASSY TREE

2000
music and libretto by Carlisle Floyd, based on the novel by Olive Ann Burns
first performance: 14 April 2000, Houston Grand Opera
setting: Cold Sassy Tree, Georgia, 1900

The citizens of Cold Sassy Tree, a small town in rural Georgia, are outraged when Rucker Lattimore, the recently widowed proprietor of the General Store, announces his intention to marry Love Simpson, a "Yankee" milliner half his age. Lattimore's two grown daughters strongly disapprove. Miss Love explains to them the arrangement for this marriage of convenience. She will cook and clean in return for the deed to the house and its furnishings. Meanwhile, Lattimore's grandson, Will Tweedy, befriends a female classmate, Lightfoot McLendon, from the impoverished Milltown, "the wrong side of the tracks." The citizens of Cold Sassy Tree shun the new Mrs. Lattimore at church. Rucker responds by conducting an impromptu service in his parlor for Will, Love and himself. Rucker and Love grow closer, as do Will and Lightfoot. Love reveals to Rucker that as a young girl she was violated and considers herself "damaged goods." Rucker tenderly proposes that she become his wife in every sense of the word. Rucker is shot in a botched robbery attempt. At his funeral party, Love announces that she is pregnant with his child. At first, many are shocked, but they finally unite to congratulate her and celebrate the forthcoming child of Rucker Lattimore.

I've known I loved you

from Act II, scene 3
setting: front porch, steps and yard of the Rucker house
character: Rucker Lattimore

While Love Simpson is away on a shopping trip, Rucker installs indoor plumbing for her, and surprises her with the news upon her return. She kisses him on the cheek in gratitude, and Rucker impulsively embraces her and kisses her on the mouth. Love is distressed and tries to pretend nothing has happened, but Rucker feels the need to make his confession of love in the aria.

DOCTOR ATOMIC

2005
music by John Adams
libretto by Peter Sellars
first performance: 1 October 2005, San Francisco Opera
setting: Los Alamos, New Mexico, and the Trinity test site at Alamagordo, New Mexico; July, 1945

Work on the atomic bomb approaches its culminating point, led by physicist J. Robert Oppenheimer and Army Commander General Leslie Groves. Scientists at Los Alamos are divided regarding the moral and social implications of their work, but pressures from Washington drive the project forward. Oppenheimer finds some rest in the poetry of Baudelaire as his wife, Kitty, contemplates the contradictions of peace, war, and love. On the night they must test the first atomic bomb, a massive electrical storm lashes the site. As panic takes hold, Oppenheimer faces his own personal crisis alone in the desert, recalling a sonnet by John Donne that inspired him to name the test site Trinity: "*Batter my heart, three-person'd God.*"

With the rain still coming down, Groves disregards all warnings about the storm, and Oppenheimer orders everybody to prepare for the test shot at 5:30 a.m. Everyone waits, each absorbed in his own thoughts. Suddenly, the night sky is filled with a terrifying vision of Vishnu as described in the *Bhagavad Gita*. At zero minus ten minutes, a warning rocket is fired and a siren sounds. Then the storm breaks, and the sky over Ground Zero suddenly clears. Another warning rocket goes off, and at zero minus 60 seconds, a third one signals the final countdown. There is an eerie silence, and then an era begins.

Batter my heart

from Act I, scene 3
character: Oppenheimer

As the date of the bomb test draws near, Oppenheimer finds himself alone, suffering anxiety under the weight of the implications of the test. He recalls one of John Donne's Holy Sonnets, "Batter my heart, three person'd God." This was the text that inspired him to name the test site "Trinity."

EL NIÑO

2000
music by John Adams
libretto adapted from poems by Rosario Castellanos, Gabriela Mistral, Hildegard von Bingen, Sor Juana Inés de la Cruz, Rubén Dario, Vicente Huidobro, Martin Luther and texts from the King James Bible, The Wakefield Mystery Plays and gnostic gospels
first performance: 15 December 2000, Deutsches Symphonie-Orchester, London Voices and Maîtrise de Paris, Théâtre du Châtelet, Paris

El Niño tells the story of the Nativity, drawing its text from a variety of sources: New Testament gospels, Old Testament prophecies, little-known episodes from apocryphal texts, and 20th-century Mexican poetry (in both Spanish and English) that lends a contemporary resonance to the opera/oratorio.

Shake the Heavens

from Part One, No. 9
character: Baritone

"Shake the Heavens" takes as its text three verses from the Old Testament book of Haggai. These words of God, a promise to shake the heavens, the earth, and the sea, are fearsome but ultimately celebratory of God's power to bring glory and peace to the earth.

A FLOWERING TREE

2006
music by John Adams
libretto adapted by John Adams and Peter Sellars, from a South Indian folktale and poems translated by A.K. Ramanujan
first performance: 14 November 2006, Orquesta Simón Bolívar and Schola Cantorum of Caracas, MuseumsQuartier, Vienna
setting: India, 2000 years ago

A beautiful, poor girl named Kumudha discovers she has the magic gift of being able to transforms herself into a flowering tree. She and her sister sell the fragrant flowers at the town marketplace. The local Prince spies on her during one of her transformations and is enchanted. He marries Kumudha. After their wedding, the prince is sullen for a few days until he commands Kumudha to perform the transformation for him. She is reluctant and resists, but finally gives in and performs the transformation ceremony, but his sister watches from a hiding place and, envious of her sister-in-law's powers, forces Kumudha to perform the ritual for her and a group of her friends. After Kumudha turns into a tree, they abandon her in a rainstorm, not having completed the water ritual which would revert her back into human shape. Trapped in a netherworld, not quite tree, not quite human, Kumudha is eventually rescued by a band of minstrels, who incorporate her into their travelling act because she can sing exquisitely. Meanwhile the prince, distraught at his wife's disappearance, wanders through the country as a beggar. He travels to a distant city, where his sister has become queen. Barely recognizing him, she takes him in, though he will not speak. When she hears about a travelling minstrel troupe and a strange tree-woman with a heavenly voice, she summons the broken hybrid to the palace, in hopes it will help the prince. At once the prince recognizes his wife's voice, and with pitchers of water restores her to her human form.

Storyteller's Aria

from Act II, scene 2
character: Storyteller

The character Storyteller functions as narrator of the plot in the opera. In this aria he describes the crisis in the love story, when Kumudha is tragically caught in transformation between tree and human form.

ФРАНЧЕСКА ДА РИМИНИ (FRANCESCA DA RIMINI)

1906
music by Sergei Rachmaninoff
libretto by Modest Tchaikovsky, based on Canto V of Dante's *Inferno*
first performance: 11 January 1906, Bolshoi Opera, Saint Petersburg
setting: The castle of Lanceotto Malatesta in Rimini, now in northern Italy, the end of the 13th century

Making their way through the circles of Hell, Dante and the ghost of Virgil come to a place of whirlwinds where they meet the spirits of those damned by lust. Here they meet Francesca and her lover Paolo and ask for their story. In life, Francesca was deceived into marrying Lanceotto Malatesta, who is disfigured yet is a great warrior. Lanceotto has had many successes in battle, but these bring him no joy, as he is tortured by jealousy and fear that his wife loves his younger brother Paolo, whom he had originally sent to woo Francesca on her father's advice. Francesca had not understood that Paolo was representing his older brother, and had exchanged vows with the younger man, believing she was to marry him. She now accepts she is Lanceotto's wife but cannot pretend to show him love. Lanceotto sets a trap. He announces he must leave for war and commits his wife to his brother's care. To entertain Francesca in her husband's absence, Paolo reads her the legendary story of Sir Lancelot and Queen Guinevere and, as he reads, connects the tale to their own situation of secret love. When he arrives at the point where Lancelot and Guinevere embrace and kiss, Francesca yields herself to him. At that moment, Lanceotto rushes in and stabs them both to death. As Dante and Virgil listen to the end of this story, the screams of the dying lovers mingle with the cries of all the other souls of the damned streaming past in the whirlwind. The two poets are left meditating on Francesca and Paolo's refrain: "There is no greater sadness in the world than to remember a time of joy in a time of grief."

Любви твоей хочу я!
(Lanceotto's Aria)

from Scene 1
setting: Rimini, Malatesta's palace.
character: Lanceotto Malatesta

Lanceotto longs for the love of his wife, Francesca, and accustomed to being a powerful man, is bewildered at feeling powerless because of his love for her.

Любви твоей хочу я!...	*It is your love that I desire!*
Погляди, на что похож стал ныне	*Look, what has become now*
грозный Малатеста!	*of fearsome Malatesta!*
Передо мной всё трепетало прежде,	*All trembled before me,*
одним движением руки	*with a single wave of my hand*
я приводил в повиновенье...	*I could bring all into submission...*
Теперь же, при тебе я робок,	*But now, with you I am timid,*
я бессилен...	*I am powerless...*
О, снизойди, спустись с высот твоих,	*Oh, deign to descend from your heights,*
звезда моя!	*my star!*
Покинь эфирные селенья,	*Leave those ethereal places,*
где спит, не зная вожделенья,	*where sleeps, not knowing lust,*
краса твоя!...	*your beauty!...*
Хоть раз, блестя лучом заката,	*Just once, like a shining ray of sunset,*
любовным пламенем объята,	*consumed by love's flame,*
пади на грудь!	*sink down to my breast!*
Огнем страстей земных согрета,	*Warmed by the fire of earthly passions,*
в сверканьи сладостного света	*in the glow of blissful light*
дай потонуть!	*let me drown!*

GLORIANA

1953, revised 1966
music by Benjamin Britten
libretto by William Plomer
first performance: 8 June 1953, Royal Opera House, London
setting: England, the later years of the reign of Queen Elizabeth I, *c*1600

At a royal tournament of jousting the ambitious Robert Devereux, Earl of Essex, picks a fight with Lord Mountjoy and is mildly wounded. Queen Elizabeth's punishment is that henceforth they shall always attend court together as friends. Sir Robert Cecil warns his monarch about Essex's unruliness, and about the likely threat of an Armada from Spain. Working on her fondness for him, Essex flatters the queen and asks to be appointed her Deputy in Ireland, to quell the rebel Tyrone. Elizabeth is evasive, conscious of her position as monarch and wary of his impetuousness. In Norwich the queen is welcomed by the citizens and entertained with a masque of Time and Concord. At the London house of Essex, the Earl, his sister Lady Penelope Rich and her lover Mountjoy plan

their advancement to power over the aging queen. Lady Essex counsels caution. At court the queen insists the ladies change after a strenuous dance; she reappears wearing the short, immodest dress of Essex's wife, shaming her. Essex is furious but mollified when Elizabeth announces the appointment he has long urged and sends him to Ireland. His campaign, however, is a failure, and on his sudden return he insists on admittance to the monarch while she dresses. He finds her in her true appearance as an old woman, without wig or make-up. He pleads his cause, but she is unconvinced and later Cecil warns her of his scheme to replace her by overthrowing the monarch. In London, the supporters of Essex fail in their attempt to win the people over to his rebellion. Essex is condemned, despite efforts of his wife to save him. Elizabeth signs the warrant for his execution. In the final scene, the dying queen recalls the tests she has withstood during her long reign.

Cecil's Song of Government

from Act I, scene 2
setting: A private apartment at Nonesuch
character: Sir Robert Cecil

After the Queen mentions how she admires the impulsiveness and arrogance of the Earl of Essex, Cecil warns her not to show too much affection in case she becomes politically entangled with him.

Cecil's Report

from Act III, scene 1
setting: The Queen's ante-room in Nonesuch
character: Sir Robert Cecil

Cecil announces to the Queen that Ireland is still in revolt, since Essex has failed to quell the rebellion. Now Essex is in England with "hangers-on unruly," and Cecil senses danger.

Raleigh's Song

from Act I, scene 1
setting: Outside a tilting ground
character: Sir Walter Raleigh

Prompted by the Queen, Raleigh offers remarks on Essex and Mountjoy, the two lords dueling for her favor.

MASS

1971
music by Leonard Bernstein
text from the liturgy of the Roman Mass
additional texts by Stephen Schwartz and Leonard Bernstein
first performance: 8 September 1971, John F. Kennedy Center for the Performing Arts
setting: A church in the present

The theatre piece *Mass* is an abstract, contemporary spiritual journey of doubts and affirmations in the context of the ritual of traditional liturgy. It was composed in a mix of classical and rock styles.

Simple Song

from Part I
character: Celebrant

Subtitled "A Hymn and Psalm," "Simple Song is sung at the beginning of *Mass* in the Devotions Before Mass section. An optional flute obbligato part is included in this edition.

A MIDSUMMER NIGHT'S DREAM

1960
music by Benjamin Britten
libretto by Benjamin Britten and Peter Pears, adapted from William Shakespeare
first performance: 11 June 1960, Aldeburgh Festival
setting: A wood near Athens, summer

As twilight falls, fairies are attendant upon their queen Tytania, followed by Puck, henchman for the fairy-king, Oberon. Tytania and Oberon arrive separately, having fallen out. They argue over a human boy, who was born to a member of Tytania's cult but died in childbirth. Tytania and her fairies leave. Incensed, Oberon seeks revenge by sending Puck to find for him a certain herb that causes those upon whose sleeping eyelids the juice is dropped to fall in love with the next live creature that he or she sees. Next enter mortal lovers Lysander and Hermia, who are forbidden by Athenian law to marry (she must wed Demetrius). As they leave Oberon enters to observe a second Athenian couple, Demetrius (in love with Hermia) pursued by Helena (in love with Demetrius). As they move off Puck returns with the herb. Taking pity on Helena, Oberon instructs him to seek out an Athenian (meaning Demetrius) and anoint his eyes so as to make him fall in love with Helena. Next, a group of Athenian workmen enter, intent on casting a play they hope to perform before Duke Theseus. Most prominent among them is Bottom, cast as Pyramus in Pyramus and Thisbe. They agree to return later to rehearse. Now the mix-ups begin: Puck mistakenly anoints Lysander's eyes, causing him to transfer his allegiance to Helena, while Oberon anoints Tytania's sleeping eyes, causing her to fall in love with Bottom, whom Puck has mischievously given an ass's head. The four Athenian mortals are hurled into violent discord, till Puck sends them to sleep and they wake up cured. Bottom too is eventually restored to his fully human self, Oberon and Tytania make their peace, and following the successful performance of Pyramus and Thisbe before noble guests (whom we met earlier in the wood), the fairies bless Theseus, his wife Hippolyta, and their house.

Bottom's Dream

from Act III. The Wood.
character: Bottom

Bottom awakes from an extraordinary dream in which he found himself in a sort of utopia. He vows to get Peter Quince to write this experience into a ballad.

O Helen, goddess

from Act II. The Wood.
character: Demetrius

Under the spell of the magic flower, Demetrius declares his sudden and furtive love for Helena.

MISS HAVISHAM'S FIRE

1979, revised 1996
music by Dominick Argento
libretto by John Olon-Scrymgeour, after sections of *Great Expectations* by Charles Dickens
first performance: 22 March 1979, New York City Opera
setting: The gardens and environs of the estate of Miss Aurelia Havisham;
Satis House, Essex, England; 19th century

The opera is cited as "Being an investigation into the unusual and violent death of Aurelia Havisham on the 17 of April in the year 1860." Jilted at the altar at her wedding, the unbalanced Miss Havisham lives for the subsequent fifty years in the seclusion of her manor home. She dies when her wedding gown, which she has always worn since the day of the wedding, catches fire. The work proceeds on two levels at once: Throughout the opera, an investigation about her death is held on one side of the stage while the explanatory action immediately follows. A series of flashbacks fleshes out the coroner's inquiry and past and present merge. During the Prologue screams are heard and a figure, enveloped in flames, appears at the window of Satis House. It is Miss Havisham. Pip rushes in to try to save her. The investigation of her death reveals the dark relationships Miss Havisham had with her adopted daughter Estella, turning her against the affection of men, and the orphan Pip. The investigation also reveals that all of the relatives involved had some motive for her death.

If in the years to come

from Act I, scene 1
setting: The garden of Satis House gone to seed, 1860
character: Pip

The opera begins near the end of the story. After many years away and after being spurned by Estella, Pip returns to Miss Havisham's dilapidated Satis House at her request. When the deluded Miss Havisham asks if he loved Estella very much, he replies with this pained aria of memory.

NIXON IN CHINA

1987
music by John Adams
libretto by Alice Goodman
first performance: 22 October 1987, Houston Grand Opera
setting: February 1972, Peking (later called Beijing), China

Nixon in China takes as its subject President Richard Nixon's historic 1972 meeting with Chairman Mao Tsetung of China, which had been closed to the West for decades. Over the course of the six-day visit, Richard and Pat Nixon and the U.S. Secretary of State Henry Kissinger meet in ceremonial public and private visits with Chairman Mao, his wife Chiang Ching, Chou En-lai, first Premier of the People's Republic of China, and their secretaries, resulting in an unprecedented exchange of stories, ideas, and ideologies. The characters express themselves in public oration, as well as expressing thoughts in private meditations and revelations

News has a kind of mystery

from Act I, scene 1
setting: The airfield outside Peking
character: Nixon

After landing on the tarmac in Peking, Nixon muses over both the significance and symbolism of his arrival, as well as his anxiety concerning the upcoming diplomatic events.

Mister Premier

from Act I, scene 3
setting: The Great Hall of the People
character: Nixon

At a great banquet, Nixon gives a speech flattering the Premier and expressing optimism about the future of American-Chinese relations.

OF MICE AND MEN

1970
music and libretto by Carlisle Floyd, after the novel and play by John Steinbeck
first performance: 22 January 1970, Seattle Opera
setting: An agricultural valley in northern California, 1930s

Of Mice and Men is based on John Steinbeck's tragic tale of two migrant ranch workers during the Great Depression in pursuit of a simple dream: to own a small house and farm of their own. George Milton travels with his companion, Lennie Small, who is mentally disabled, but has the physique and strength of a giant, and a love for soft things he can stroke and pet. The two have constant problems with their employers, as Lennie unknowingly creates difficulties for George and himself. George is frequently exasperated but forgives Lennie and both are sustained by their dream. Curley is the contentious and jealous son of a ranch owner who hired George and Lennie. George and Lennie are joined in their plans for a home by the old ranch hand Candy, whose savings bring them near their goal. Suddenly, however, they lose all prospects: Curley's flirtatious and lonely wife invites Lennie to stroke her soft hair, but when he does not stop, she begins to scream in terror. Fearing he will get into trouble again, Lennie tries to stifle her screams and unwittingly kills her. George, while placating Lennie with thoughts of their long-held dreams, shoots his friend to save him from a brutal lynching.

George's Aria

from Act II
setting: The bunkhouse
character: George

George expresses his longing for a better life for Lennie and himself, and seems certain that they will achieve their dream of owning their own farm house.

OUR TOWN

2006
music by Ned Rorem
libretto by J.D. McClatchy, based on the play by Thornton Wilder
first performance: 24 February 2006, Indiana University Opera Theater
setting: Grover's Corners, New Hampshire, 1901-1913

The Stage Manager (narrator) introduces two families from a small American town: Dr. and Mrs. Gibbs and their teenaged son George; and newspaper editor Mr. Webb, his wife, and their teenaged daughter, Emily. We hear daily life in the two households, with the inkling of romance between George and Emily. Act II begins three years later, with George and Emily about to be married, with a flashback to their courtship. Act III takes place nine years later. In Wilder's innovative stylization, the dead in the graveyard are sitting quietly on chairs; among them is Mrs. Gibbs. Emily is being brought to the cemetery, after having died in childbirth. She asks if she can return to life for one day, and she chooses her thirteenth birthday. Soon it is unbearable, seeing how no one realizes the importance of every second of life. After she returns to her grave, the Stage Manager philosophically ends the story as the life on this world continues.

When I got married

from Act II
setting: The Gibbs' home
character: Mr. Webb

In a scene between George Gibbs and his future father-in-law, Mr. Webb relays the advice given him by his father about marriage.

THE RAKE'S PROGRESS

1951
music by Igor Stravinsky
libretto by W.H. Auden and Chester Kallman
first performance: 11 September 1951, chorus and orchestra of the Teatro all Scala (Milan)
at Teatro la Fenice, Venice
setting: England, the 18th century

In the idyllic countryside, Anne Trulove and Tom Rakewell celebrate their love. Anne's father, who has doubts about the proposed marriage of the two, attempts to arrange a job for Tom in the city, but Tom resists. After Anne and her father leave, Tom declares his wish to live by his wits and trust his luck. Nick Shadow appears with news that Tom has inherited a fortune from an unknown uncle. Shadow offers his services as servant, saying that Tom need only pay for his services after a year and a day. Tom and Nick leave for London. In the wicked den in the city, Shadow introduces Tom to Mother Goose's brothel. Back in the country, Anne fears the worst and decides that she must rescue Tom. Meanwhile, Tom, in his new London house, is already bored with ordinary pleasures. He wishes for happiness, so Shadow makes the outlandish suggestion that he marry Baba the Turk, the famous bearded lady. When Anne arrives at Tom's house, she is horrified to find him married to the hideous Baba. When Tom tires of Baba as well, Shadow appears with one last new idea: a machine that turns stones into bread (which Tom doesn't realize is a sham). Anne again appears to save Tom, but this time his house is for sale and his property for auction. The bankrupt Tom has disappeared with Shadow. Baba urges Anne to follow him.

A year and a day from their first meeting, Shadow brings Tom to a graveyard at night. A terrified Tom discovers he must pay not with money but with his soul. Nick offers one chance for escape in a card game, which Nick wins as Tom hears Anne's voice in the distance and correctly guesses the queen of hearts. Defeated, Shadow curses Tom with insanity before he disappears into the ground. Tom is shut up in Bedlam. Anne comes there to comfort him, but there is little to be done. Her father arrives and persuades her to leave Tom to his fate. In an epilogue, the principals sing a moral: "For in idle hands and hearts the devil finds a work to do."

Come, master

from Act II, scene 1
setting: The morning room of Tom's house in a London square
character: Nick Shadow

After a little while in London, Tom becomes unsatisfied and unhappy. Shadow makes him an unlikely proposition: Tom should marry Baba the Turk, a bearded lady famous across Europe. Tom reacts incredulously, but Shadow convinces him of the plan with a devious aria: men are unhappy because they are not free, and to be free, they must abandon both reason and desire.

I burn! I freeze!

from Act II, scene 2
setting: A churchyard with tombs, a starless night
character: Nick Shadow

Nick Shadow has demanded payment from Tom, not money, but his soul and forfeiture of his life. When Tom does not kill himself, Nick instead proposes a game. He will cut three cards. If Tom can name them, he is free. If not, Tom must follow Nick into death. Aided by Anne's love, represented by her singing off-stage, Tom wins the game. As the defeated Nick sinks into the ground, he condemns Tom to insanity.

THE RAPE OF LUCRETIA

1946, revised 1947
music by Benjamin Britten
libretto by Ronald Duncan, after André Obey's play *Le Viol de Lucrèce*
first performance: 12 July 1946, Glyndebourne Festival
setting: In or near Rome, 500 BCE

The Male and Female Chorus describe the historical background to the story and reveal their view of events to be that of a later, Christian era. The action is set in and around Rome immediately before the end of the reign of the Etruscan king Tarquinius Superbus in 510 BCE. At a military camp outside the city, his son, the prince Tarquinius Sextus, is drinking with two generals, Collatinus and Junius. They discuss an earlier, unfortunate bet, in which the constancy of various Roman wives was tried and found wanting. Of the married men (Tarquinius goes to brothels) only Collatinus can boast a wife, the chaste Lucretia, who was discovered sleeping alone in her husband's absence. Urged on by the malicious Junius, Tarquinius decides to test Lucretia's virtue by attempting to seduce her and rides off to Rome. The arrival of the prince of Rome produces bewilderment and consternation, but requirements of hospitality force Lucretia to offer him a room for the night, despite her misgivings and those of her servants. Tarquinius's purpose, however, is made clear when he wakes her and rapes her. The following

morning Lucretia's late appearance in a distressed, broken state is only slowly understood by her nurse Bianca and maid Lucia. Lucretia sends for her husband. Collatinus arrives with Junius to hear the news of Tarquinius' crime. Despite his at least partial and sympathetic understanding of Lucretia's shame, it is too painful for her to bear. She stabs herself. Her death provides the impetus for the Romans to throw out the Tarquins. The Male and Female Chorus attempt to come to terms with these events in a Christian context as a moral conclusion.

Lucretia! I'm sick of that name!

from Act I, scene 1
setting: The Army Camp
character: Junius

Prince Tarquinius is drinking at night in his tent with the Roman generals Collatinus and Junius. The Male Chorus as narrator sings, "Last night some generals rode back to Rome to see if their wives stayed chaste at home." This was to settle a bet. Junius and Tarquinius then list the many unfaithful wives and their deeds. Collatinus calls them "fools to set the honour of your wives against a drunken bet!" Tarquinius then relates that Lucretia, wife of Collatinus, was the only wife who was found safely at home, "the only wife who stood the test." After some argument between Junius and Tarquinius, Tarquinius then makes a toast to the chaste Lucretia. Junius rushes out of the tent and angrily begins the aria.

Tarquinius's Aria (Within this frail crucible of light)

from Act II, scene 1
setting: Lucretia's bedroom
character: Tarquinius

In late evening Tarquinius has ridden the short distance to Rome from his army camp, intent on seducing the chaste Lucretia. Lucretia and servants are bewildered at his arrival, but etiquette demands hospitality to the prince of Rome. Tarquinius claims his horse is lame. Reluctantly, Lucretia shows him to his bedroom. Later, as Lucretia sleeps, Tarquinius enters her room and lusts after for in this aria, which precedes him raping Lucretia.

THE SHOEMAKERS' HOLIDAY

1967
music by Dominick Argento
adaptation and original lyrics by John Olon-Scrymgeour, based on the play by Thomas Dekker
first performance: 1 June 1967, Tyrone Guthrie Theater, Minneapolis
setting: London, *c*1600

This one act "ballad-opera" is an adaptation of Thomas Dekker's play of the same name, written in London around 1600. A high-spirited celebration of virtue and good fortune, the story centers around the shop of Simon Eyre, the shoemaker of the Lord Mayor of London. Rowland Lacy, the Earl of Lincoln's nephew, is in love with Rose, the Lord Mayor's daughter. Neither the Earl nor the Mayor wish the two to wed, however, and they contrive to separate the lovers. Lacy is sent abroad to fight in the army, but deserts and returns to London in the guise of a Dutchman, working in Eyre's shop. Simon Eyre ascends to become Lord Mayor himself and, in that capacity, secures the King's blessing for Lacy and Rose to be wed.

Simon's Aria

character: Simon Eyre
setting: Simon's shoemaker shop

Simon sings his aria upon his ascension to Lord Mayor, and it swirls with both excitement and a recognition that mad fortune, and not reason, has provided for his accomplishment.

SUSANNAH

1956
music and libretto by Carlisle Floyd
first performance: 24 February 1956, Florida State University
setting: Summer, the recent past, New Hope Valley in the mountains of Tennessee

The opera is loosely based on the biblical story of Susanna and the elders from the book of Daniel. The eighteen-year-old, beautiful Susannah Polk lives with her brother Sam in their mountain cabin. At a square dance as the opera opens, the gossiping ladies of the church scorn Susannah, jealous of the attention the men give her. The new Reverend Olin Blitch arrives for the first time to the valley during the gathering and dances with Susannah. The next morning the church elders are searching for a stream to use for baptisms, and from a distance observe the innocent and naked Susannah bathing in a creek near the Polk cabin. The lustful elders spread the word of her "sin." At a church supper that night the whole town is convinced that Susannah is of the devil. Susannah is bewildered at the cold reception she receives and is told she isn't welcome. Her simpleton friend Little Bat admits to her that he told the elders that "you'd let me love you up," even though it is a lie. Sam convinces Susannah she must go to the revival meeting to show she isn't afraid. The choir is singing and Reverend Blitch is preaching and bringing repentant converts to the altar. Susannah, in a trance, moves toward the altar, but comes to life, looks around and screams "no!" She runs out of the church. Later that night Blitch comes to Susannah's cabin. Blitch is convinced of her sinfulness, despite Susannah's protests. He seduces her, and Susannah gives up and submits. The next morning a remorseful Blitch prays for forgiveness, as he realized that Susannah was "untouched" before his touch. He tries to convince the congregation of Susannah's innocence, but fails. Susannah tells her drunk brother Sam that Blitch seduced her. He goes to the creek and while the preacher is baptizing shoots and kills him. The angry mob comes for Susannah and Sam, believing Susannah put Sam up to it. She laughs wildly at the mob and waves her gun, chasing them away.

I'm a lonely man, Susannah

from Act II, scene 3
setting: The Polk mountain cabin, evening
character: Olin Blitch

After the elders have seen Susannah bathing naked in the spring, the entire town thinks she is immoral. Preacher Blitch visits her to save her soul, though Susannah sharply denies any wrongdoing and claims her innocence. She breaks down in sobs. Though conflicted, Blitch cannot resist his urges and starts his reluctant, exhausted seduction and confession of desire in this aria.

Hear me, O Lord

from Act II, scene 4
setting: The interior of New Hope Church.
character: Olin Blitch

Blitch sings his Prayer of Repentance, alone in his church, as too late he realizes Susannah's innocence and the weight of his own sin.

TROUBLE IN TAHITI

1952
words and music by Leonard Bernstein
first performance: 12 June 1952, Festival of the Creative Arts, Brandeis University
setting: Any American city, and its suburbs.

Set in a comfortable American suburb near a large city, the story is one day in the life of a couple, Dinah and Sam, married ten years. Dinah is a restless, lonely housewife who questions her bickering, uncommunicative relationship with her husband, who seems to be most interested in playing handball and furthering his career. The opera's title comes from a mindless but captivating Hollywood movie *Trouble in Tahiti* that Dinah has seen. *Trouble in Tahiti* was the second of three one-acts that played on Broadway in *All in One*, which opened on 19 April 1955. Most of *Trouble in Tahiti* was incorporated into *A Quiet Place*, which has the same characters and their descendants 30 years later.

There's a law

from Scene 5
Setting: A Gymnasium
character: Sam

Sam and Dinah's nine-year old son is playing the lead role in his school play. Sam, despite Dinah's arguments with him, insists on skipping the show and instead playing in a handball tournament at his gym. Afterward, in the locker room, having won the handball trophy, Sam declares that he's one of the winners in life, oblivious to the way he's distancing himself from his family.

A WATER BIRD TALK

1977
music by Dominick Argento
libretto freely adapted by the composer from *On the Harmfulness of Tobacco* by Anton Chekhov and *The Birds of America* by J.J. Audubon
first performance: 19 May 1977, Brooklyn Academy of Music
setting: A summer evening in the second half of the 19th century;
the rostrum of a provincial club in Maryland, perhaps Virginia.

A middle-aged gentleman is delivering a lecture on water birds. The opera is performed as if directed towards the lecturer's audience. While describing the habits of various birds, in front of projected slides of Audubon's illustrations, he unwittingly draws parallels with his own life. The cormorant's young never leave the nest; the male phalarope attends to domestic duties while the female flits about. Ultimately, he reveals himself as an unhappy man, henpecked by his off-stage wife and laughed at by his daughters.

The Lecturer (Theme)

character: The Lecturer

The beginning of the Lecturer's speech immediately evinces his nervousness and timid deference to his wife, who sits unsympathetically in the wings.

WILLIE STARK

1981
music and libretto by Carlisle Floyd
based on the novel *All the King's Men* by Robert Penn Warren
first performance: 24 April 1981, Houston Grand Opera
setting: An unnamed southern American state capital, 1935

Willie Stark, based on the book *All the King's Men* by Robert Penn Warren, is inspired by the life and career of Louisiana governor Huey Long. The title character has risen from a humble background to become governor of a state in the deep South. He is the grassroots champion of the working class, but behind his "country boy" image Willie Stark is also a shrewd and ruthless politician, willing to stretch the law whenever he feels constricted by its boundaries. The story follows Willie's schemes to avoid impeachment for re-ordering the state's legal system to achieve his political ends. Although his attempts to do so are successful, Willie leaves many ruined lives in the wake of his political ambition. Inwardly he is torn by a profound conflict between the idealistic man who entered politics several years before and the corrupt politician he has become. Meanwhile, he falls in love with socialite Anne Stanton. She is to marry Jack, whose father, the highly respected Judge Burden, favors the impeachment. Willie asks Anne to break off her engagement with Jack and marry him instead; she agrees to do so. Willie's longtime political associate and advisor, Sadie, finds them together and lashes out at him, since she is no longer the only woman in his life. Judge Burden is accused of bribery and Jack finds evidence to support this, though he does not want to believe it is true. After Jack confronts his father, Judge Burden takes a pistol from his desk and ends his life. A few days later, Jack is distraught when Sadie tells him of Anne's plans to marry Willie. As Willie gives a speech in celebrating of his victory, Jack steps out of the crowd and fires a pistol at Willie, killing him. As someone in the crowd tries to intervene, Jack is killed too.

We all come out of the earth

from Act I, scene 3
character: Willie Stark

During a rally on the courthouse steps of his hometown of Madison City, Stark is suddenly moved by the sight of a young boy with a harmonica in the crowd. Reminded of himself in his own youth, Stark buys the harmonica from the boy. Losing his usual politician's toughness, he recollects his life's journey and realizes that he is homesick for the vision of himself that he has left behind.

ARIAS AND ROLE EXCERPTS FOR BARITONE

Batter my heart

DOCTOR ATOMIC

Libretto by
PETER SELLARS
drawn from original sources

Music by
JOHN ADAMS

The tempo is deliberately ♩ = 136, not ♩. = 136.

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Solennemente

♩ = 58

10 **OPPENHEIMER:**

Bat - ter my heart, three per - son'd God; for,

espressivo ***p***

etc.

15

you as yet but knock breathe, knock, breath,

18

knock, breath, shine, and seek to mend;

mp *espressivo*

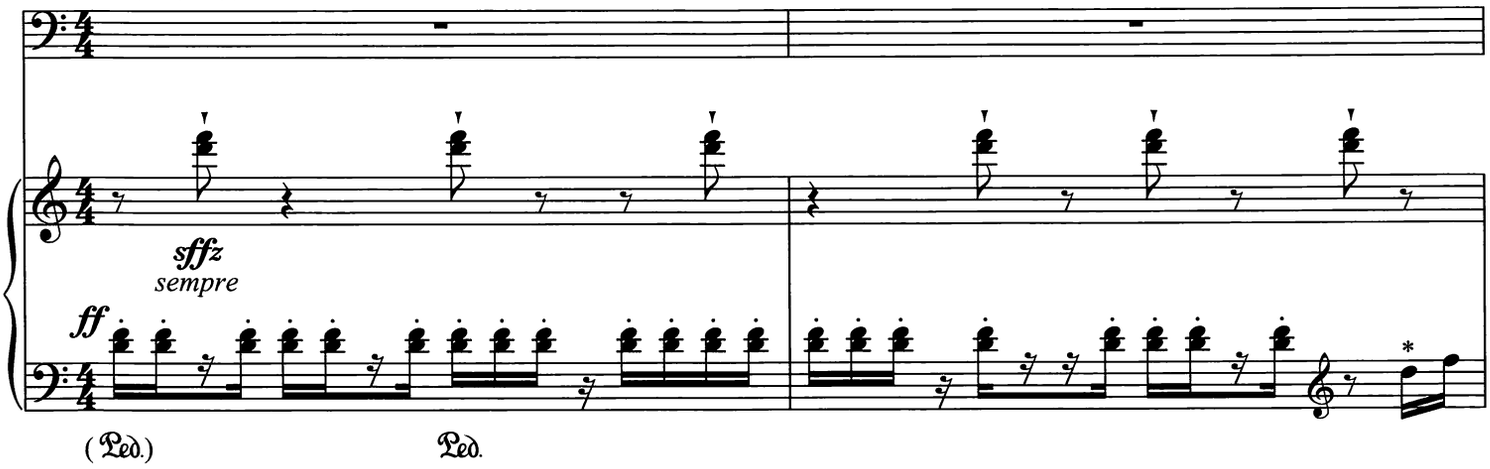
8vb

21
Bat - ter my heart, three per - son'd God; that I may rise and
(8vb)
26
stand, o - 'er - throw me, and bend Your force, to break, blow,
espressivo
p
mp
30
break, blow, break, blow, burn and make me new.
sfp
f

Animato ♩ = 104

The eighth in measure 1 equals
the new sixteenth note in measure 34.

34



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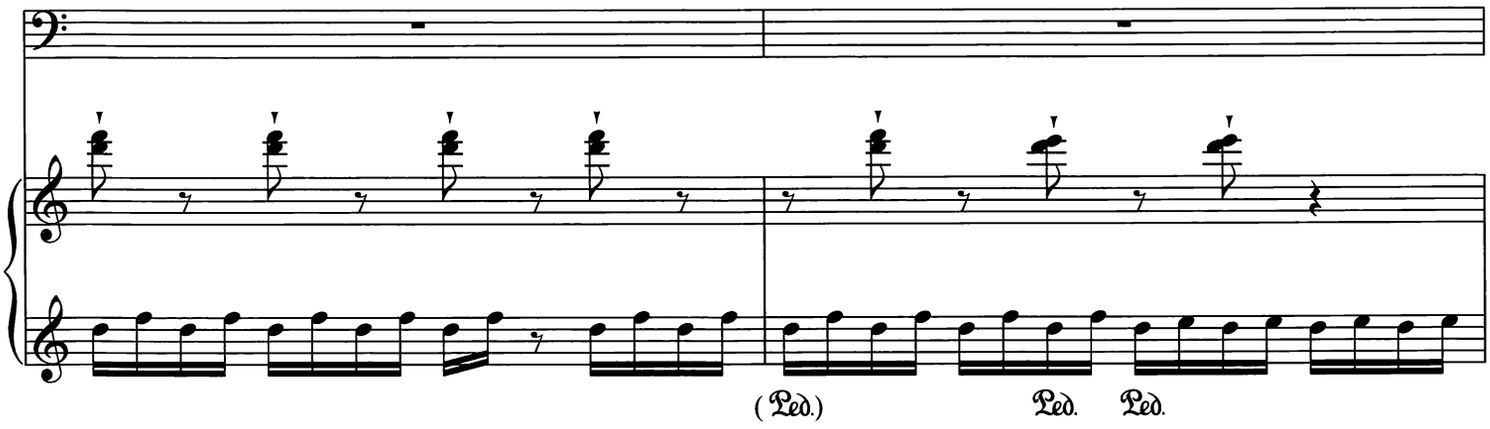

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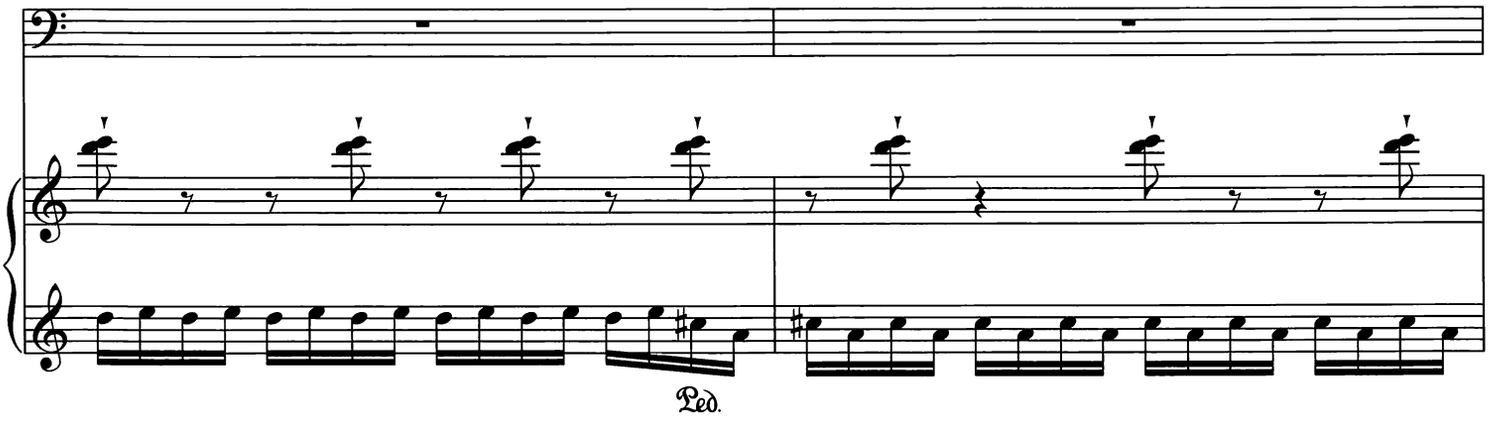

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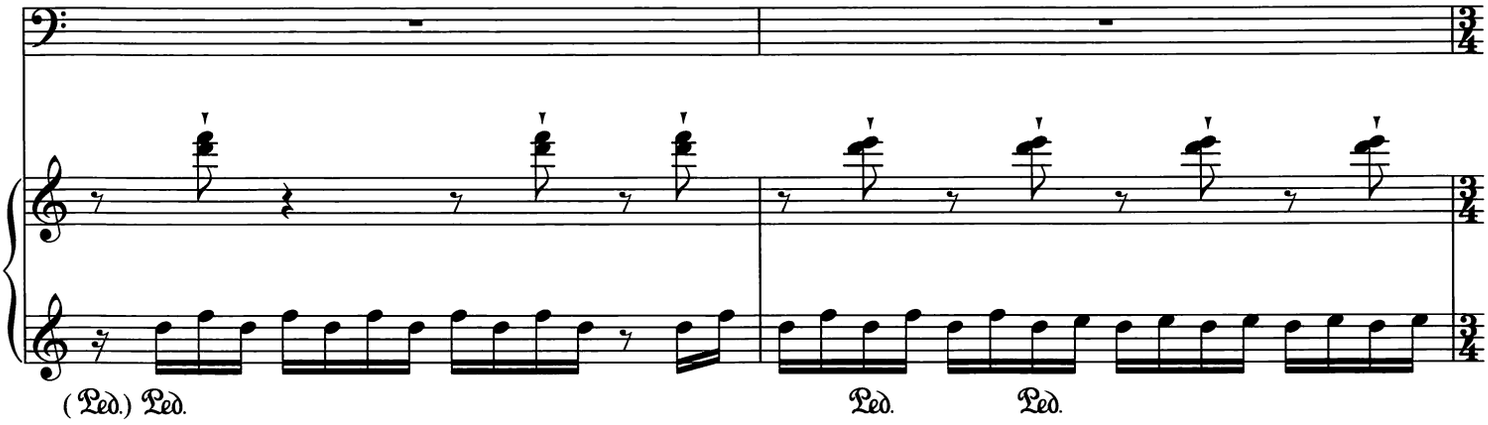


* For fuller sonority, L.H. may play one octave lower through beat one of m. 43.

42

Slower tempo again
♩ = 58

pp sub.

Ped. Ped. Ped.

45

Bat - ter my heart,

p

48

three per-son'd God; for, you As yet but

p

3

p

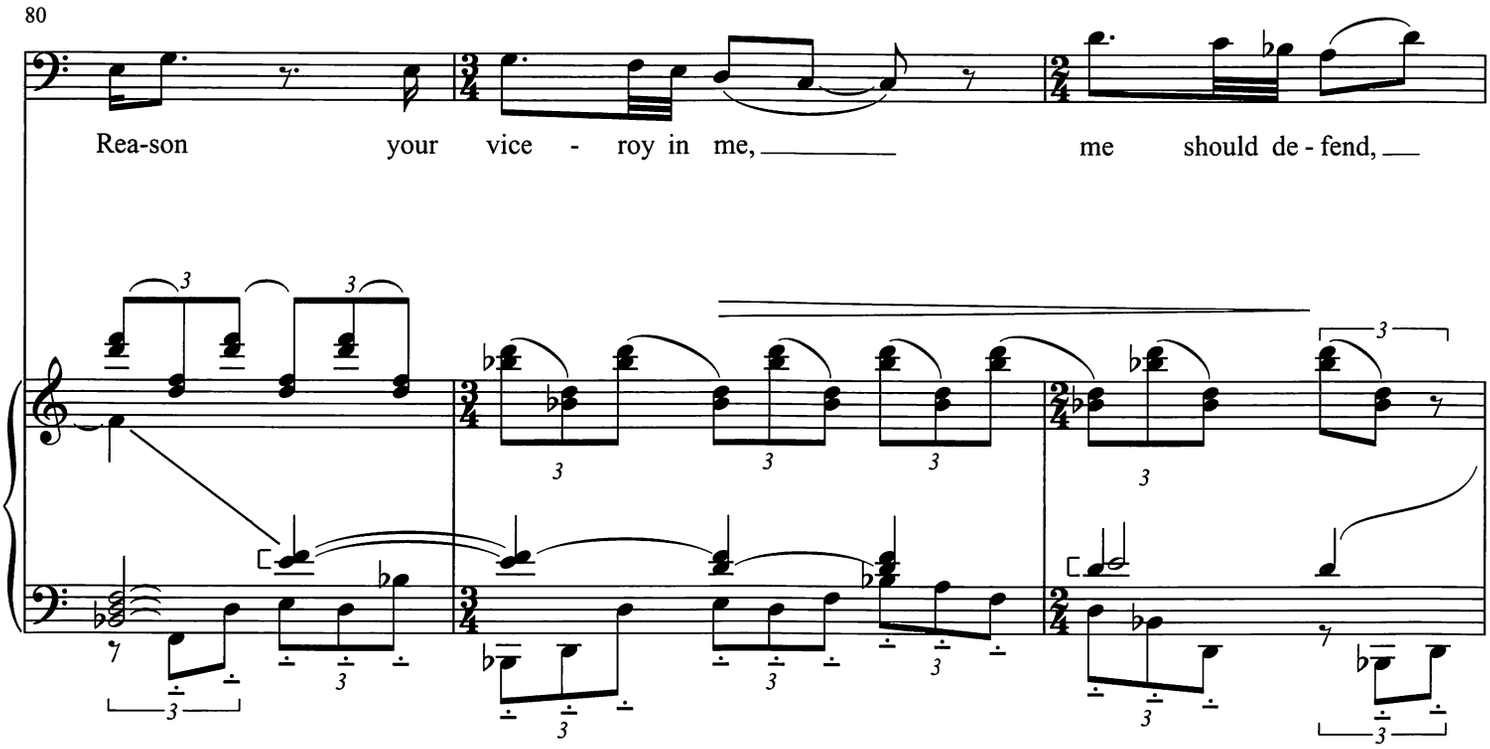
p

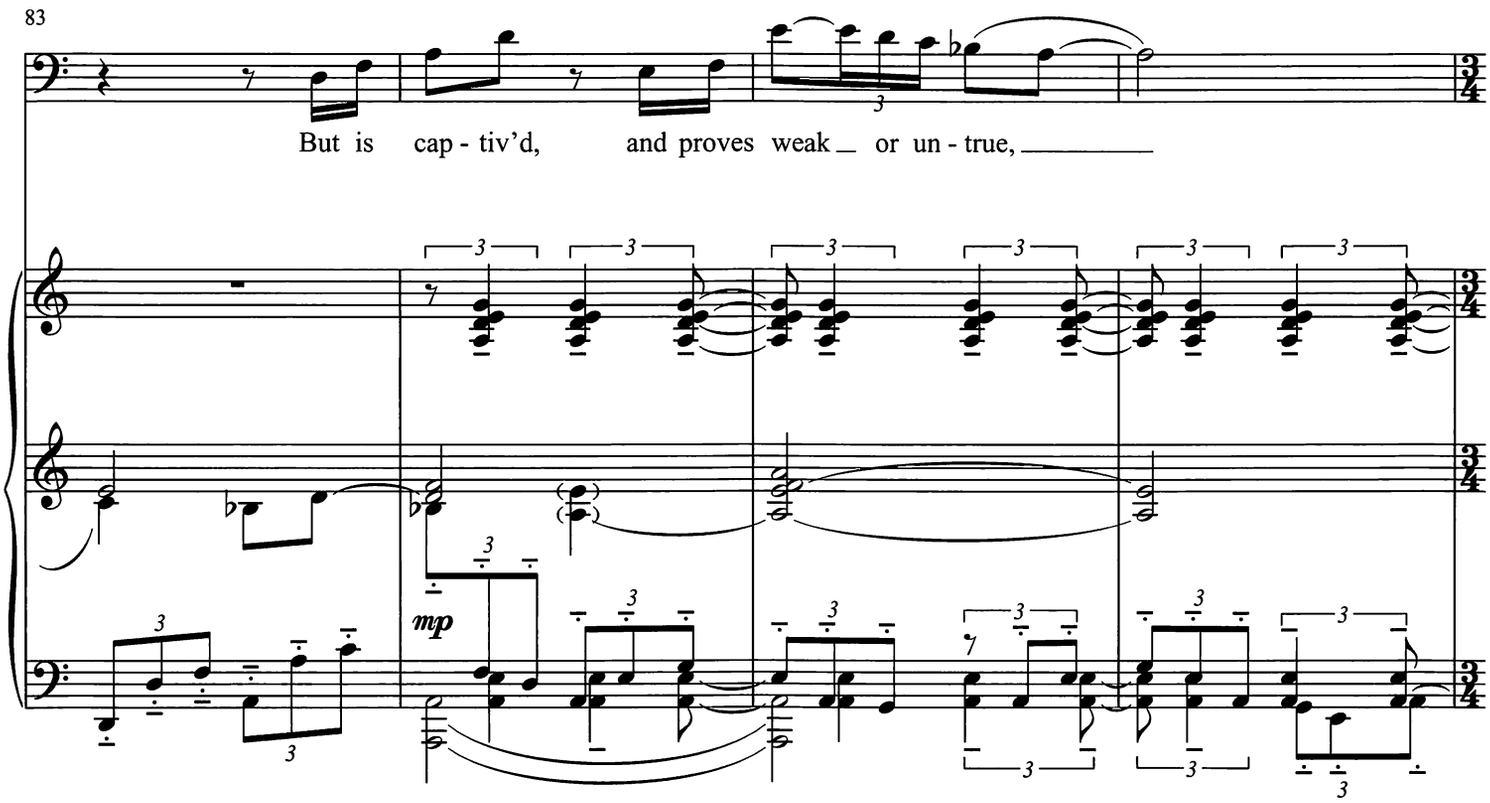
p

51
knock, breathe, knock, breathe, knock, breathe, shine, and
mp
p
54
seek to mend; Bat - ter my heart, three per - son'd
mp
mf
p
59
God; That I may rise, and stand, o - 'er - throw me, and
3

63
bend Your force, to break, blow, break, blow,
L.
66
break, blow burn and make me new.
mp
Ped.
69
I like an u - surpt town, to - 'an - oth - er due,
pp
delicately
etc.

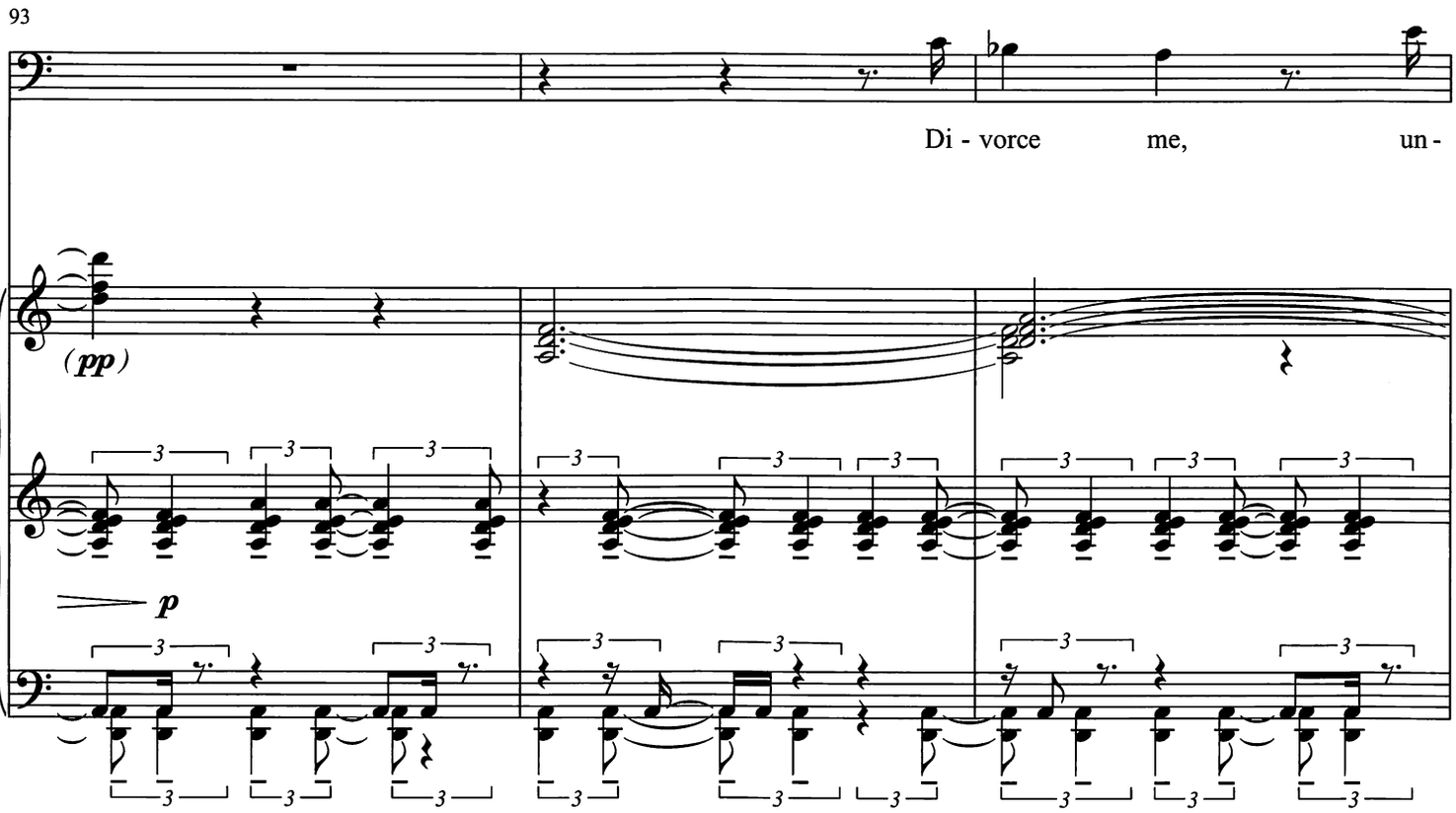
72
La - bour
to'ad -
75
mit you,
but
Oh,
sempre pp
sempre leggiero
77
to no end,
pp


80
Rea-son your vice - roy in me, me should de - fend,


83
But is cap - tiv'd, and proves weak or un - true,
mp

87
Yet dear - ly' I love you, and would
p
89
be lov'd fain, But am be - troth'd
mf
p

91
un - to your en - e - my,
mf
mf
mf


93
Di - vorce me, un -
(pp)
p

96
tie, or break that knot a - gain,
p

99
Take me to you, im -
ppp

101
pris - on me, for I, ex - cept you' en - thrall me,
p
104
nev - er shall be free, Nor ev - er chaste, ex - cept you
(p
p
)
107
ra - vish me.
(
)
sfp

Storyteller's Aria

A FLOWERING TREE

Libretto adapted by
PETER SELLARS and JOHN ADAMS
from a South Indian folktale
and poems translated by A.K. Ramanujan

Music by
JOHN ADAMS

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13
spilled the pitch-er of wa - ter. They broke the tree's
f
mf
17
bran - ches, tore off its flow - ers, and they ran
21
off, leav-ing Ku-mud-ha a - lone. It be-gan to
(♪ = ♪) ♩ = 116
sf
sf sf mf
24
rain, and Ku - mu - dha strug-gled, strug - gled,
mf
sf sf
p
p

27
strug - gled, strug - gled, strug - gled, strug - gled to re - gain her hu - man
sf sf mf
p
sf
p
30
form a - gain. But she could - n't, she could - n't.
8va
f
sf sf
33
She could not gain her hu - man form a - gain.
8va

* A cut was made here of the orchestral interlude for this aria arrangment.

54
wife,
58
a stump of flesh, a shape - less thing, a
sf
sf
sf
62
twist - ed, mu - ti - la - ted bod - y with nei - ther, nei -
sf
f
66
ther, with nei - ther hands nor feet.
mf
p

69
She crawled like a worm
73
to a rain - soaked gut - ter
77
and passed the night there,
80
(♪ = ♪) ♩ = 116
a wound - ed car - cass.
f
sf
f

News has a kind of mystery

NIXON IN CHINA

Libretto by
ALICE GOODMAN

Music by
JOHN ADAMS

The lines of Chou En-lai and the male chorus have been eliminated in this solo edition of the aria.

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14
has a, has a, has a kind of mys - ter- y:
19
Has a, has a, has a kind of mys - ter - y:
24
When I shook hands, When
8va
loco
8va
loco
mf
29
I shook hands with Chou En-lai, When I shook hands with Chou En-lai on

33
this bare field out - side Pe- king_ just now, the whole world was lis - ten-ing.
f
37
The whole world was lis - ten- ing. Lis - ten-ing.
mf
f
41
Lis - ten - ing. And
sim.
ff
p subito
45
though we spoke qui - et - ly, And though we spoke

49
p subito
qui - et - ly, And though we spoke qui - - -
mf
p subito
53
- - - - - - et - ly the eyes and
57
ears of hisss - to-ry, hisss - to-ry, hisss - to - ry
61
caught ev - ery gesss - ture – Caught ev - ery
f

65
gesss - ture– Caught ev - ery gesss - ture and ev - ery
69
word, trans - form - - - - - -
sim.
73
- - - - - ing us as we, trans - fixed,
77
Trans - form - ing us as we, trans - fixed,

81
Trans - form - ing us as we, trans - fixed, made hisss - to - ry.
85
Hisss - to - ry. As we made
89
hisss - to-ry. The eyes
mf
93
and ears of hisss - to-ry, As
sim.
f

98
we made hisss - to- ry.
sim.
f
ff
103
On our flight o - ver from Shang -
sim.
p subito
sempre secco
sim.
108
hai The coun - try - side looked drab and
113
grey. "Brue-ghel," Pat said.
f

118
"We came in peace for all man - kind"
p subito
mp
122
I said, I said, I said, I
127
said, I said,"We came in peace for all man - kind" and
mp
8va
loco
132
I was put in mind of our A - pol - lo
8va
loco

136
as - tro - nauts
sim - ply a - chiev - ing a great hu - man
mf very short
sim.
141
dream.
We live
p
146
in an un - set - tled time.
mf
Ped.
*
151
We live in an un - set - tled time.
f
Ped.
*

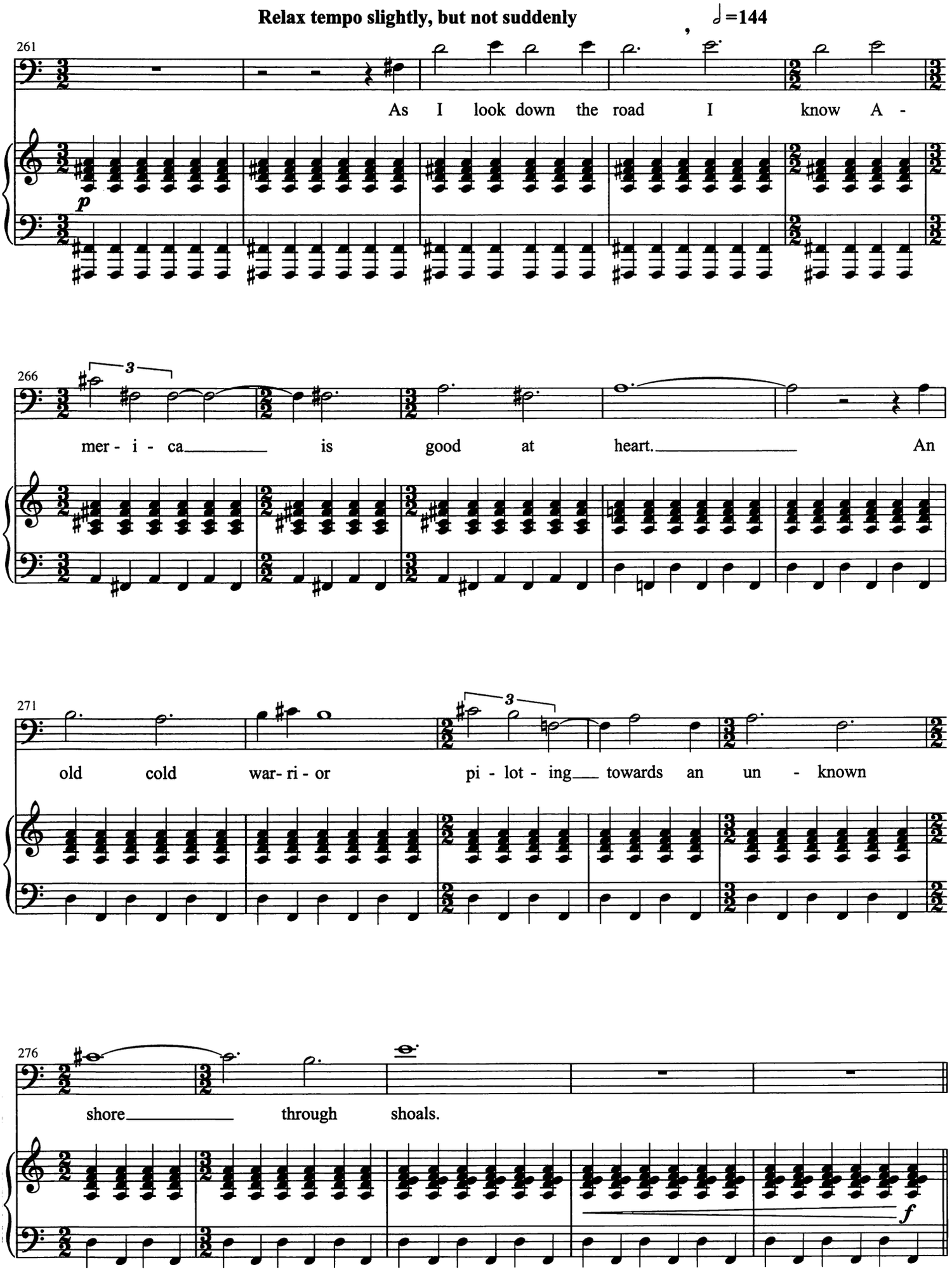
156
Who, who, who, who, who are our en-e-mies?
mf
f
Ped.
160
Who, who, who, who, who are our friends?
mf
f
Ped.
165
Who are our friends?
ff
169
The East - ern Hem - i - sphere_ beck-oned to us,_____ and
3
p
sim.
Ped.
Ped.

174
we have flown east of the sun, west of the moon
Ped.
Ped.
179
a - cross an o - cean of dis -
Ped.
184
trust filled with the bod - ies
pp
p
(Ped.)
Ped.
189
of our lost; The earth's Sea of Tran -
Ped.

194
quil - li - ty.
The earth's Sea of Tran - quil - li - ty,
199
Tran - quil - li - ty,
The
204
earth's Sea –
pp
p
209
News! News! News! News! News!
sim.
ff
f
secco
sim.

215
News! News! News! It's prime time in the U. S. A. It's
f
221
prime time in the U. S. A. It's yes - ter-day night.
225
It's yes - ter-day night. Yes - ter-day night. They
229
watch us now; The three main net-works' col-ors glow
p
sim.
sim.

236
liv- id through drapes on - to the lawn.
243
Dish - es are washed and home - work done, the dog and grand-
pp
249
- ma fall a - sleep, A car roars past play - ing loud pop,
p
256
is gone.
f
p


Relax tempo slightly, but not suddenly
♩=144
261
As I look down the road I know A -
p
266
3
mer - i - ca is good at heart. An
271
3
old cold war- ri - or pi - lot - ing towards an un - known
276
shore through shoals.
f

281
The rats be-gin to chew the sheets. The
sim.
mp secco
sim.
286
rats, The rats be-gin to chew the sheets. The rats be-gin to chew the sheets. The
291
rats, the rats be-gin to chew the sheets. The rats, the rats be-gin to chew the
296
9:6
7:6
sheets.
There's mur-mur-ing down be-low.

Gradual relaxation of tempo
301
There's mur-mur-ing, There's mur-mur- ing, mur- mur-ing. Now there's in -
sfz
p
306
- gra-ti-tude! My hand is as stead-y as a rock.
f
p
sim.
sim.
311
A sound like mourn-ing doves
317
♩ = 138 Steady tempo
reach - es my ears, No-bod-y is a friend of ours.
sfz
p

323
The na - tion's heart - land skips a beat As our
sfz
p
329
hands shield the spin-ning globe from the flame - throw- ers
mf
335
of the mob. We must press on.
Begin gradual relaxation of tempo
340
We know we want –
p
sim.
Ped.

Mister Premier

NIXON IN CHINA

Libretto by
ALICE GOODMAN

Music by
JOHN ADAMS

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12
so en - joyed a din - ner, nev-er have_ I
8va
loco
16
so en - joyed a din-ner, nor have I heard
19
played bet-ter the mu - sic that I love out - side A -
24
p
mer - i - ca.
8va
loco
mp
mf
Ped.
*

27
I move a vote of thanks to one and
sfz
mf secco
sfz
30
all whose ef - forts made this pos - si -
sfz
sfz
33
ble.
No one who heard
f
sfz
sfz
mf
sfz
36
3
could but ad - mire your el - o - quent re - marks, Pre -

38
mier, and mil-lions more
8va
40
3
hear what we say through sat - el - lite tech - no - lo -
(8va)
44
gy than ev - er heard a pub - lic speech be -
(8va)
loco
48
fore.
8va
loco

51
No one is out of touch.
No one, No
p
54
one,
No one is out of touch.
57
sim.
60
64 (3+2)
Te - le - com - mu - ni - ca - tion has broad - cast your mes - sage

68
in - to space. Yet soon our words won't
8va
Ped.
* Ped.
72
(3+2+2)
be re-called while what we do can change the world.
(8va)
* Ped.
* Ped.
77
(8va)
♩. = 144
(♩ = ♩.)
loco
mf secco
(♪ = ♪)
sim.
82
86
We have at times been en - e - mies, we still have

91
(falsetto)
(2+3)
dif-feren-ces, God knows.
96
But let us, in these next five days
101
start a long march
cresc. poco a poco
106
on new high - ways, in
f
Ped.
Ped.

111
dif - ferent lanes, but par - al - lel
115
8:9
and head - ing for a sin - gle goal.
Ped.
Ped.
120
Agitato
The world
ff
f
125
8:9
watch - es and lis - tens. We must seize the

sempre agitato
129
f
hour,
We must seize the hour,
sim.
più f
sim.
134
8:9
We must seize the hour,
We
138
must seize the hour
and seize the
Ped.
*
♩. = 𝅗𝅥 = 160
143
day.
ff
sim.

If in the years to come

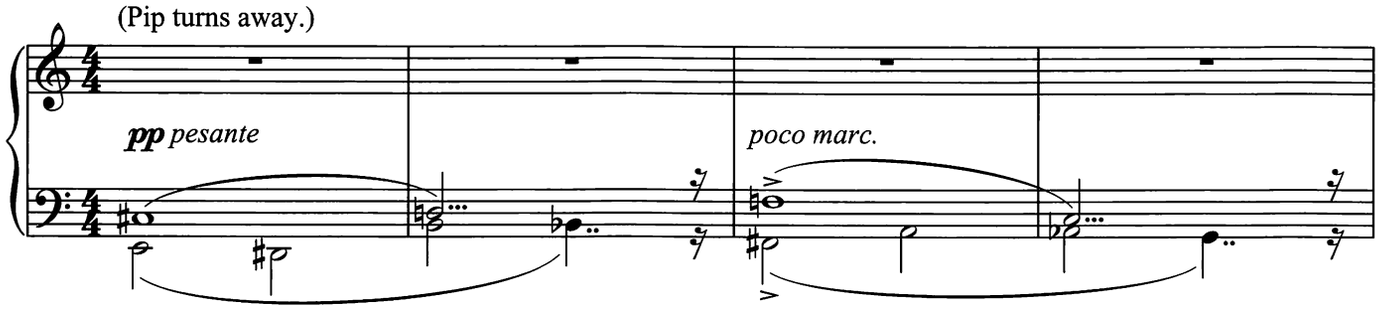
MISS HAVISHAM'S FIRE

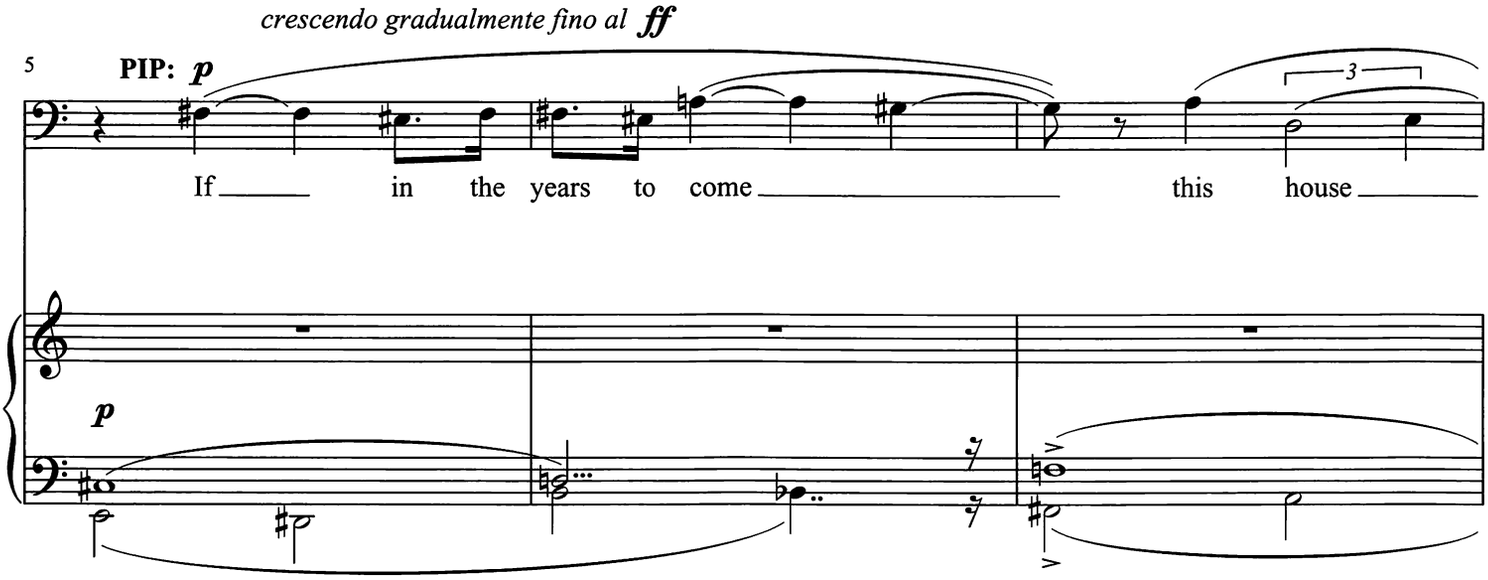
Libretto (after Dickens) by
JOHN OLON-SCRYMGEOUR

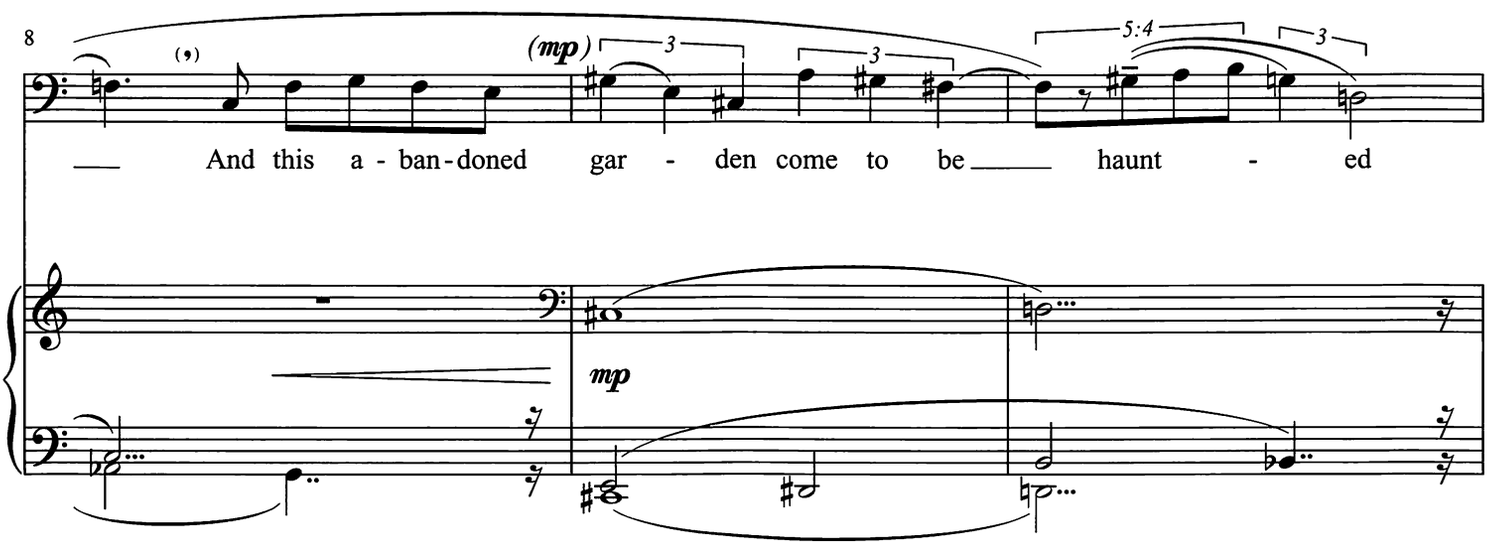
Music by
DOMINICK ARGENTO

Largo e doloroso ♩ = c. 58

(Pip turns away.)







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11
5:4
(mf)
It will be my ghost sure - ly That wan - ders the halls,
poco
sfz
mf
14
wan - ders the paths. Let my bo - dy be where it
17
ten.
(f)
will, In this life my spir - it wan - ders,
ten.
ten.
ten.
ten.
f

(Pip is in tears. Miss Havisham stares at him intently.)

20

ff molto commosso

ten.

wan - ders and haunts these halls and paths. If in the

poco sfz

ten.

ff

ten.

23

f

mf

years to come... if in the years to come... the

f

26

mp

p

tronco

years... the years... the years...

mf

mp *p*

sfz - pp

What a yielding nature she has

THE ASPERN PAPERS

Based on the Henry James novella

Music and Libretto by
DOMINICK ARGENTO

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10
strange-ly e-nough, she had not the least air of re - sent-ing my want of con-sid-er-
15
mp
a - tion. She en - joyed it ev - en
p
20
more than she told— she was not just pleased: she was trans -
cresc.
poco a poco accelerando
poco più f
mf
23
port - ed. The whole thing was an im - mense lib - er -
pp
mp
mf
mp
mf

52 Quasi allegretto ♩ = 104
decresc.
27
f
a - tion. And still, as she looked out ov - er the charm-ing
(coll' 8va)
f
mf
poco a poco rall. al tempo I
Tempo I ♩ = 80
31
mp
scene, her face had, in spite of its smile, the flush of wound-ed sur - prise
pp lontano
p
36
as if she were think-ing with a sec - ret sad - ness of
8va
mp
p
pp sotto voce
42
cresc.
op - por-tun - i - ties, for - ev - er lost, which ought to have been
(8va)
cresc.

rall. **Espansivo quasi maestoso ♩ = c. 72**

47

mp poco a poco cresc.

eas - y: that some - how for the best years of her life, she had been

rall.

p *(coll' 8va)*

51

sempre cresc.

mf

cheat - ed of the world, cel - eb - rat - ing mys - tic

mp *mf*

54

f *f* *decresc.* *mp* *poch. decresc.*

rites of en - nui here in her

f *mp*

58

rall. *a tempo* *p* *poco cresc.*

aunt's dark - ened rooms.

rall. *pp* *poch. cresc.* *p*

a tempo

You have already heard one sermon tonight

CASANOVA'S HOMECOMING

Libretto and Music by
DOMINICK ARGENTO

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10
poco cresc. ed accel.
poco più f
love liv - ing.
"My sys - tem, if it can be called a sys - tem, Has been to
p poco cresc. ed accel.
mp
14
cresc. poco a poco
(mf)
con impeto
Poco ritenuto
glide a - way un - con - cern - ed - ly on the stream of life Se - que - re
cresc. poco a poco
(mf)
f
18
ff
mf
A tempo
mp dolce
cresc.
mf decresc. e poco rall.
De - um-
Trust - ing to the wind wher - ev - ver it
ff
mf
p
cresc.
mf decresc. e poco rall.

Andantino alla barcarola ♪ = c. 88
22
mp
pp
led.
mp
cantabile assai
3
For hap - py or mis-er - a - ble,
mp
(mp)
subito molto tratt.
p
Molto largo ♪ = 58
25
pp
mp
cresc. poco a poco
Life is the on - ly bless-ing man pos - - sess - es
And those who do not love it are un -
più p
colla voce
pp cresc. poco a poco
(p)
Più mosso
con urgenza
28
mf
f
3
wor - thy of it."
Prize it a - bove all things
And
(mp)
(mf)
f brillante

* Gabrielle's line has been cut in this solo edition of the aria.

The Lecturer

(Theme)

A WATER BIRD TALK

Libretto freely adapted from
On the Harmfulness of Tobacco by Anton Chekov
and *The Birds of America* by J.J. Audubon

Music by
DOMINICK ARGENTO

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Stesso tempo ma espansivo
10
quasi parlato e senza rigidità
hold an - y learn-ed de - grees. I have, how-ev-er, o-ver the past thir-ty years, de-vel-oped a cer-tain ca-
mf legato e cantabile
13
pac - i - ty for ob-ser-va-tion. More and more, it has be - come my ha - bit sim - ply to...
16
ob-serve; to ob - serve the world a - bout us and to stud-y all man- ner of things; to try to

19
f
mf
un - der - stand and to share that un - der - stand - ing with oth - ers.
Some years a - go, I com -
22
poco più f
mf
posed a ver - y long es - say en - ti - tled: "Scor - pi - ons, Spi - ders and Cen - ti - pedes."
My daugh - ters all seemed to en - joy it –
25
cresc. poco a poco
es - pe - cially those sec - tions on spi - der's webs
and how they serve as
both nest and trap –
cresc. poco a poco
f

28
f
mf
(looks to the wings for help; listens, nods, turns back to audience.)
f
but their moth - er thought it was…
it was…
…'Re - vul - sive'.
(cresc.)
(His attention is immediately called to the wings again; listens, nods, turns back to announce the correction.)
(to the wings)
ff
32
tronco
più f
'Re-pul- sive'.
Well, it real-ly does-n't mat-ter:
ff
mf sub.
(to the audience)
36
dolce
I tore it up an - y - way.
This eve- ning I would like to talk a - bout
mp sub.
cresc. poco a poco
legato

39
"Wa - ter Birds" and the hu - man sig - ni - fi - cance of our feath - ered neigh - bors.
mf
41
cresc. poco a poco
And I will ac - com - pany these brief re - marks with some il - lus - tra - tions of my
cresc. ancora
43
f
own de - sign.
mp
I must tell you first that, fond as I am of birds, I have a
tr
tr
f molto
p dolce

46
cresc.
ter - ri-ble dread of wa-ter a com-plete-ly ir - ra-tion-al fear of drown-ing. But my wife in-sist-ed:
cresc.
49
(cresc.)
'Don't you dare em-bar-rass me a - gain– none of your aw-ful bugs: I warn you!'
f
52
mf
So Wa - ter Birds it shall be.
dim. e rall.

A Simple Song

MASS

Lyrics by
STEPHEN SCHWARTZ and LEONARD BERNSTEIN

Music by
LEONARD BERNSTEIN

*Repeat if acoustically necessary

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16
Poco meno mosso ♩ = 88
, ppp
all, For God is the sim - plest of all.
ppp
p (sempre tranquillo)
21
p
I will sing the Lord a new song To praise Him, to bless Him, to
25
bless the Lord. I will sing His prais - es while I live
28
meno p
All of my days. Blessed is the man who
p
meno p

32
cresc.
mf
loves the Lord, Blessed is the man who prais-es Him.
cresc.
mf rhythmic (but lightly)
35
dim.
p
mf
Lau - da, Lau - da, Lau - dē... And walks in His ways. I will
[p]
dim.
p
39
lift up my eyes To the hills from whence comes my help. I will
mf warmly
cresc. poco a poco

43
p
pp
lift up my voice to the Lord Sing-ing Lau-da, Lau-dē For the
47
cresc. poco a poco
mp
mf
Lord is my shade, Is the shade up - on my right hand, And the
cresc. poco a poco
51
cresc.
non dim.
sun shall not smite me by day Nor the moon by night.
f

55
f sempre
mf dim. poco a poco
Bless-ed is the man who loves the Lord, Lau - da, Lau - da,
f sempre
rhythmically
mf dim.
58
p
Lau - dē And walks in His ways.
p
62
Solo
espr.
[p]
espr.

65

molto rall. e dim.

molto rall. e dim.

Cadenza (freely)

69 *quasi* ***f*** *dim.* ***p***

Lau-da, Lau-da, Lau - dē Lau-da, Lau-da di da di day...

quasi ***f***

73 **A tempo (più lento)**

All of my days.

quasi rall.

pp

p

quasi rall.

pp

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Flute

A Simple Song

MASS

Lyrics by
STEPHEN SCHWARTZ and LEONARD BERNSTEIN

Music by
LEONARD BERNSTEIN

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The Vicar's Aria

Virtue, says Holy Writ

ALBERT HERRING

Words by
ERIC CROZIER

Music by
BENJAMIN BRITTEN

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Music © Copyright 1948 by Hawkes & Son (London) Ltd

10
Rar - er than... pearls ru - bies am - e - thyst,
express.
13
poco cresc.
Rich - er than... wealth, wis - dom right - eous - ness!
poco cresc.
singing (cantabile)
16
Is Al - bert vir - tu - ous? Yes? or
ppp
poco marcato
20
no? That is all we need to

*Ensemble lines have been eliminated in this solo edition.

Tickling a trout

ALBERT HERRING

Words by
ERIC CROZIER

Music by
BENJAMIN BRITTEN

Text © Copyright 1947 by Hawkes & Son (London) Ltd
Music © Copyright 1948 by Hawkes & Son (London) Ltd

10
cresc.
pp light
court-ing a girl is the King of all sports in a class of its own
Where there
pp cresc.
f
13
aren't a - ny rules so long as she's caught and you catch
her a - lone.
ppp
pp cresc. molto
With a swing ♩. = 52
16
f
sempre f
Girls mean
Spring six
days a week
and twice on
fz
ff express.
21
Sun - days,
The whole year round,
the win - ter through.
p cresc.
ffz
ff

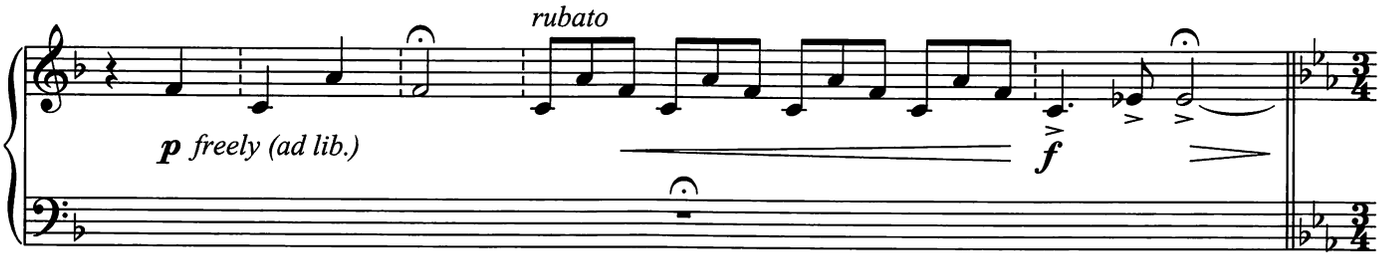
26
f
Girls mean: games of hide and seek On sum-mer eve-nings, When some-one's
sf
ff
p cresc.
pp
32
f
bound To fall for you! Girls mean: prowl - ing
ffz
ff
sf
ff
pp
37
poco a poco dim.
round in bleak and win - try wea - ther whis - p'ring, whis - p'ring, whis-p'ring,
poco a poco dim.
Ped.
pp (falsetto)
43
pp very sweetly
"I love you, I love you, I love you, love you!"
ppp
mf
ppp
ppp

Churchyard's agog with a crowd of folk

ALBERT HERRING

Words by
ERIC CROZIER

Music by
BENJAMIN BRITTEN



Slow and dignified ♩ = 56

SID: ***p*** *parlante e sempre liberamente*

2

Church-yard's a - gog with a crowd of folk who could - n't get in for the

4

ser - vice. Seats have been kept for the Band of Hope, and each

ppp *sust., expr.*

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7
choir boy has got a new sur - plice.
10
The Vi - car is preach-ing on 'Liv - ing Chaste For the Here-
fpp
fpp
13
pp
af - ter.' Some of his listen-ers are
rather heavy
ppp
fp
16
so - lemn - faced, Some near to laugh - ter. And
pp light
uneasily
p
fp
ppp

animating
20
cresc.
Al - bert! sit - ting there in his pew, The poor kid looks
pp
poco marc.
poco a poco cresc.
23
sempre più f
on ten - ter - hooks. He's in the mood to es - cape if he
26
slower
ppp
could:— I'd like to see him go for
fz
pp
29
good!
rubato
pp cresc.
f
p

Billy Budd, king of the birds!

BILLY BUDD

Words by
E.M. FORSTER and ERIC CROZIER

Music by
BENJAMIN BRITTEN

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8
Look - ing down on the deck, Look - ing down on the waves.
sfp
8vb
10
mf
Work - ing a - loft with my mates.
mf
12
Work - ing a - loft in the fore - top.
14
giocoso
Work - ing and help - ing, work - ing and
f marc.
f

16
shar - ing.
Good -
f
f
19
bye to the old life,
don't want it no more.
f
f
sfp
22
Fare - well to you old com - rades!
3
3
f
sfp
25
Fare - well to you for e - ver!
3
sfp
f

* Ensemble and chorus parts begin here, eliminated in this excerpted version.

Billy's Farewell

Look! Through the port comes the moonshine astray!

BILLY BUDD

Words by
E.M. FORSTER and ERIC CROZIER

Music by
BENJAMIN BRITTEN

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15

cresc.

But 'twill die in the dawn-ing of Bil-ly's last

pp

18

espr.

day. Ay, ay, ____ all is up; and I must up too Ear-ly in the

p espr.

pp

22

più f

morn-ing, a-loft from be-low. On an

ppp

p

25

em - pty stom-ach, now, ne-ver would it do. They'll give me a nib-ble-bit of

dim.

28
bis - cuit ere I go. Sure, a mess - mate will reach me the last part - ing
31
pp
cup; But turn - ing, turn - ing, turn-ing heads a -
ppp
ppp
34
ppp (words! – parlando)
way From the hoist and the be - lay. Hea - ven knows who will have the run-ning of me up!
ppp
37
No pipe to those hal - yards—
8va
f
f lively
pp

40

pp

But ain't it all sham? A blur's in my eyes; it is dream-ing that I

43

pp espr. *cresc.*

am. But Don-ald he has prom-ised to stand by the

ppp *pp*

46

dim.

plank, So I'll shake a friend-ly hand ere I sink. But no! no!

pp

49

pp *più p*

It is dead then I'll be, come to think. They'll

ppp

52
lash me in ham-mock, drop_ me deep,
più p
più pp
55
ancora più p
Fa-thoms down, fa-thoms— how I'll dream fast a - sleep. I feel it steal-ing now;_
ppp
58
dolce
pppp
roll me o - ver fair.
pppp
ppp
61
sempre pp
I'm sleep - y and__ the oo - zy weeds a - bout me__

*Dansker's exchange with Billy is cut in this solo edition of the scene.

83
sea, No look - ing down from the heights to the depths.
p
88
But I've sight - ed a sail in the storm,
93
cresc.
The far - shin - ing sail that's not fate, And
mf
cresc.
98
f
freely
3
a tempo
I'm con - ten - ted, I've seen where she's bound for.
fp
pp
p

103
cresc.
She has a land of her own where she'll an - chor for
cresc.
107
freely
e - ver. Oh, I'm con - ten - ted. Don't mat - ter now be - ing
fp
pp
ppp
113
a tempo
cresc.
hanged, or be - ing for - got - ten and caught in the
p
cresc.
118
f
weeds. Don't mat - ter now.

122
broadly
ff
sempre f
I'm strong, and I know it, and I'll stay strong,
ff
p
pp
p
p
mf
128
dim.
4
I'll stay strong and that's all, all, all, and that's e - nough,
p
mf
p
pp
p
pp
ppp
135
getting slower and slower
pp
that's e - nough, that's e - nough.
poco a poco più lento
ppp
ppp
142
rall.
ppp
Rather lively (♪)
3
3
3
pp
3
3
pp

Cecil's Report

GLORIANA

Libretto by
WILLIAM PLOMER

Music by
BENJAMIN BRITTEN

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11
act - ion He for - feit-ed his chan - ces. And
f
dim.
15
now it is Sep - tem - ber, Too late for new cam-paign - ing
pp
18
And now he's here in Eng-land, With han - gers-on un -

21
ru - ly, Armed, and out for trou - ble,
f
p
mf
24
f
Ma - dam, I see a cer - tain dan - ger,
p
27
p
rit.
pp
I see a cer - tain dan - ger.
pp

Cecil's Song of Government

GLORIANA

Libretto by
WILLIAM PLOMER

Music by
BENJAMIN BRITTEN

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9
pp
si - lence _ and de - lay:
Blaz - ing bon-fires left to
ppp
pp
12
pp
burn _
Will soon, will soon con - sume them-selves a - way.
Of e - vils choose the
ppp
pp
15
pp
more marked
least:
Great foes will
tum - ble down in time, _
Or
ppp
pp
18
pp
wi-ther, one by one:
He _ that rules must hear and see _
What's
ppp
pp

21
pp
o - pen - ly or dark - ly done. All that is not e - nough:
ppp
pp
24
cresc.
There comes a mo - ment when to rule Is to be swift and bold:
cresc.
26
Know_ at last the time to strike– It may be when the iron is
p
mf
28
pp
cold!
p
It may be when the iron is
ppp
cold!
ppp
p
ppp

O Helen, goddess

A MIDSUMMER NIGHT'S DREAM

Libretto adapted from William Shakespeare by
BENJAMIN BRITTEN and PETER PEARS

Music by
BENJAMIN BRITTEN

Very impetuous ♩ = **88**

DEMETRIUS:

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10
lips, these kis - sing cher - ries, temp - ting grow!
13
That pure con - gea - led white, high Tau - rus'
17
snow, Fann'd with the east - ern wind, turns to a crow, When

20
cresc.
thou hold'st up thy hand. O let me kiss
p
f
p
slow cresc.
23
(mf)
This Prin - cess of pure white, this seal
mf
26
of bliss.
f

Lucretia! I'm sick of that name!

THE RAPE OF LUCRETIA

Libretto by
RONALD DUNCAN

Music by
BENJAMIN BRITTEN

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8
cre - tia! Lu - cre - tia! I'm
opt.
cresc.
10
sick
ff
12
of that name! Lu - cre - tia!
dim.
dim.
mf
p
15
leggiero
Her vir - tue is The mea - sure of my shame.
p
mf

17
Her vir - tue is The mea-sure of my shame.
cresc.
19
cresc.
Lu-cre - tia!
Lu-cre - tia!
mf cresc.
ff
21
ff
Now all of Rome Will laugh at me,
24
ff
Now Rome will laugh at me,
p
Or what is worse will
ff
sf
pp

27
pi-ty me, will pi-ty me, will pi-ty me. Lu-
pp
ff
cresc. molto
30
cre - tia! Lu - cre - tia! Lu -
f
sf
ff
32
cre - tia! Lu - cre - tia! Lu - cre - tia! Lu -
dim.
dim.
34
cre - tia!
f
p

*A section sung by Male Chorus has been cut.

44
più f
Col - la - ti - nus will gain my fame with the Ro-man mob,
mp cresc.
mf cresc.
46
cresc.
f
Not be-cause of bat-tles he has won— but be-cause Lu -
f cresc.
48
p
cre - tia's chaste— and the Ro-mans be-ing wan - ton wor - ship
ff
50
ppp
chas - ti-ty. Lu-cre - tia!
pp
ppp
pp
pp
pp
dim.

Tarquinius's Aria

Within this frail crucible of light

THE RAPE OF LUCRETIA

Libretto by
RONALD DUNCAN

Music by
BENJAMIN BRITTEN

Allegretto comodo ♩. = 32

(legatiss.) (Tarquinius stands at the head of Lucretia's bed.)

ppp

Molto tranquillo ♩ = 80

9

TARQUINIUS: *pp espress.*

With - in this frail

più espress.

molto espress.

pp

15

cru - ci-ble of light Like a chry - sa-lis con -

pp

sempre espress.

18

poco cresc.

pp

tained With-in its silk ob-li - vi - on. How luck-y is this lit-tle

pp

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22
espress.
pp
light, It knows her na - ked - ness, And when it's ex - tin-guished It en-
pp
pp
25
pp
vel - ops her as dark - ness, Then lies with her as
mf
dim.
28
poco f
night. Love - li - ness like this is ne - ver
pp
ff
31
meno f
chaste; If not en-joyed, it is just
p
mf
dim.
f

poco agitato

34

pp senza voce

waste. Wake up, wake up, wake up, Lu - cre - tia! Wake up Lu -

pp

sim.

40

*

sempre pp

cre - tia, wake up, wake up, Lu - cre - tia, wake up, wake up, wake up, Lu -

47

cre - tia! wake up, wake up, wake up, Lu - cre - tia! wake up,

53

poco rall.

wake up, wake up, Lu - cre - tia! wake!

poco rall.

pp

*Female Chorus lines have been omitted in this solo edition.

più tranquillo

59 *più espress.*

As blood red ru - bies Set in e - bo -

pp

62

ny. Her lips il - lu - mine The

p *poco cresc.*

65

black lake of night. To wake Lu - cre - tia with a

pp *pp*

68 (♩ = ♩)

kiss Would put Tar-qui-nius a-sleep a - while.

pppp

ppp *ppp*

distinto

George's Aria

OF MICE AND MEN

Based on the novel and play by
JOHN STEINBECK

Libretto and Music by
CARLISLE FLOYD

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14
noth-in' in the world that be-longs to me!
sfz
sfz mp
f
sfz
18
L'istesso tempo più cantabile
p
Sick and old in a bunk-house some-where:
p espressivo
21
rup-tured, fee-ble, an' des - ti - tute with
25
Rallentando
no-bod-y a-round, not a face you know, to care wheth-er you live or die.
mp
p

Un poco andante e piangendo ♩= 58
29
p
An un - used ra-zor blade, left be-hind; a
p
p
32
worn-out truss and a fad-ed neck - tie; an old har-mon-i- ca and a burnt-out pipe,
36
all that's left to say you've once been a - live.
pp
Risoluto assai ♩= 69
40
f
No! There's got-ta be more to liv-in' than that! There's just
mf più marcato

43
got-ta be more! I won't set- tle for such a stin-gy life!
f
46
I won't set -tle for that! There's just got - ta be some - thin'
L'istesso tempo, più appassionato
48
more! An' there will be more for
fp cresc. poco a poco
f
50
Len-nie an' me! There will be more!

Allegro poco maestoso ♩= 92
52
f passionately
You'll see!
I'll nev - er set - tle for this life, we're
f molto cantabile
56
not like all you lone - some guys.
We've got our own life, our
f sempre
61
own dream. We're dif - f'rent: we're not a - lone.
ff
ff
66
fff

We all come out of the earth

WILLIE STARK

Music and Text by
CARLISLE FLOYD

Allegro moderato ♩ = 96-104

WILLIE:

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Andante sempre sostenuto ♩ = 80

10

p

we all come out of the earth, an' the

13

place we come out is our home. We all come out of the

16

earth like the oak tree, ___ or like the grass.

20 **Poco più mosso ♩ = 84**

But the grass and oak tree nev - er ___ move; ___ they stay

pp

poco a poco più mosso

23

mp

all their lives in just one place. But man is born to

p

26

wan - der a - broad, to see new plac - es, new parts of the

29

mf

earth. He walks down un - fa - mil - iar streets an'

mp

8vb

loco

32

looks in - to un - known fa - ces; he lies in strange beds

crescendo

35
in the dark an' lis - tens to un - fa - mil - iar sounds.
38
Allegro inquieto ♩ = 104
f mp più marc.
40
mp
And with the new plac - es,
mf
p
mf
p
42
new sounds an' new streets, comes such a clam - or of
mf

44
mf
peo - ple an' things, that he for - gets the old voic - es, old
mf
46
f
streets, and old fa - ces; he e - ven for - gets who he is.
mf
f
49
mp
An' then the hun - ger starts, a vague an' name - less hun - ger,
p
mf p
tr
51
3
mp
gnaw - in' at him, gnaw - in' at his heart, spread - in' through him like some
mp
p cresc. poco a poco
Ped.

53
cresc.
f
ter - ri - ble fe - ver, de-mand - in' to be filled.
tr
(tr)
56
stentato
f
rall.
stentato
An' then it comes to him, comes to him that he's
sfz mp
Allegro ma largamente ♩ = 100
59
home - sick, that deep, deep in his
ff molto cantabile
62
soul he is home - sick.

65
mf
Home-sick for old
mf sempre cantabile
diminuendo
68
fa - ces, old voic - es, old streets;
mp
71
stentato
dim.
for a self, for a self he left be -
p
74
hind when he first wan - dered a - broad.
pp

Thus Gamesters united in friendship

THE BEGGAR'S OPERA

Words by
JOHN GAY
With alterations and additions by
TYRONE GUTHRIE

Music by
JOHN GAY
Realized by
BENJAMIN BRITTEN

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13
They flock to their prey at the dice box - 's
17
sound, And join to pro - mote one an - o - ther's de -
21
ceit. But if by mis - hap, They
25
fail of a chap, To keep in their hands, they each

29
oth - er en - trap. Like Pikes, lank with hun - ger, who
34
miss of their ends, They bite their com - pan - ions, and
39
prey on their friends. But
1
2
44
cresc.

Каватина Алеко
Aleko's Cavatina

АЛЕКО
ALEKO

Libretto after Alexander Pushkin's poem "The Gypsies" by
VLADIMIR J. NEMIROVICH-DANCHENKO

Music by
SERGE RACHMANINOFF

Moderato

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Allegro ma non troppo

15

f *dim.* *mf*

грусть-ю я то-мим? Я без за - бот, без со - жа-

mf *p* *p* *mf*

18

p

лень - я ве - ду ко - чу - ю - щи - е дни.

cresc. *f*

20

f *rit.*

Пре-зрев о - ко - вы про - све-

f

22

con spirito

ще - нья, я во - лен так же, как о - ни, я

mf *pp*

24
cresc.
во - лен так же, как о - ни. Я жил, не
cresc.
26
при - зна - ва - я вла - сти судь - бы ко-вар - ной и сле-
dim.
28
p
cresc.
пой. Но, бо - же, как иг - ра-ют стра - сти мо - ей по-
pp
pp
31
pp
ten.
слуш-но - ю ду - шой!... Зем - фи - ра! Как о - на лю - би - ла!
espressivo
f
ppp
p

35
rit.
Meno mosso
Как,
dim.
rit.
pp
39
con anima
неж - но при - кло - нясь ко мне, в пус - тын - ной ти - ши -
41
mf
cresc.
не ча - сы ноч - ны - е про - во - ди - ла!
f
p
Как час - то
p
cresc.
mf
43
p
ми - лым ле - пе - тань - ем, у - по - и - тель - ным лоб - зань - ем за -
pp
pp

45
mf
p
p
p
думчивость мою в минуту разогнать умела!
47
Я помню: с негой, полной
49
страсти, шептала мне она тогда:
51
„Люблю тебя! В твоей я власти!

53

Тво - я, А - ле - ко, на - всег - да!“ _____

55 **Con moto**

И всё тог - да я за - бы-вал,

57

ког - да ре - чам е - ё вни-мал

59

и, как бе - зум - ный, це - ло - вал е - ё ча -

61
ру - ю - щи - е о - чи, кос чуд - ных прядь, тем - не - е
63
но - чи, у - ста Зем - фи- ры...
66
А о - на, вся не - гой, страсть - ю пол - на,
69
при - льнув ко мне, в гла - за гля - де - ла...

* Editorial suggestion for auditions.

Original Ending
82
8va
ff
ff
(8va)
86
pesante
fff
89
fff
dim.
mf
p
mf
93
p
p
pp

Любви твоей хочу я!
Lanceotto's Aria

ФРАНЧЕСКА ДА РИМИНИ
FRANCESCA DA RIMINI

Libretto after Dante by
MODEST TCHAIKOVSKY

Music by
SERGE RACHMANINOFF

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7
ки я при - во - дил в по - ви - но - ве - нье...
cresc.
ff
9
dim.
Те - перь же, при те - бе я ро - бок, я бес-
dim.
p
p
pp
L'istesso tempo ♩ = 60
12
f cantabile
mf
cresc.
f
си - лен... О, сни-зой - ди, спу-стись с вы - сот твоих, звез -
p
16
mf
cresc.
да мо - я! По-кинь э - фир-ны-е се - лень - я, где спит, не

20
f
ten.
mf
зна - я вож - де-ле - нья, кра - са тво - я!... Хоть раз, блес - тя лу - чом за - ка - та,
23
mf
f
ff
лю - бов-ным пла - ме-нем объ - я - та, па - ди
un poco cresc.
cresc.
26
f
dim.
mf
на грудь! Ог - нем страс - тей зем-ных со-гре - та, в свер - ка - ньи
f
dim.
p
30
p
mf
p
сла - достно - го све - та дай по - то - нуть!
dim.
pp

When I got married

OUR TOWN

Libretto by
J.D. McCLATCHY
Based on the play by Thornton Wilder

Music by
NED ROREM

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10
f
If her con - ver - sa - tion ir - ri - tates you, just leave the
14
house. Do things your__ way. And nev - er, nev - er let_ your wife__
18
know how much mon-ey you have. Show her the back of your hand. Do you un-der-
22
stand?
I
mp
p

26
took the op-po-site view of my fath-er's ad-vice, and I've been hap - py ev - er since.
30
There's a les-son for you, George: in per-son-al mat-ters nev-er ask for ad-vice.
34
Pa - tience and an op - en heart, George, that will suf - fice. That will suf - fice.
f
38
ff
R.H.
8vb

Sie gibt mir keinen Blick

ARABELLA

Libretto by
HUGO VON HOFMANNSTHAL

Music by
RICHARD STRAUSS

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10
sie lässt mich stehn und geht.
p sf
14
Hab' ich was an - de - res ver - dient? Was ist ver -
mf espr.
mf sf
l.
17
dient auf die - ser Welt? Ver-dient ist
dim.
20
nichts. Stock - prü - gel sind ver-dient
f
mf
3
f
f

poco più tranquillo

23

für ei - nen Kerl_ wie mich— a - ber ge -

26

schenkt hätt' ich ger - ne ei - nen Blick_ ge - nom - men—

espr.

(Welko erscheint mit einem Glas Wasser auf einem Tablett, sieht Mandryka fragend an)
(Welko appears with a glass of water on a tray, Mandryka looks questioningly)

30

so ei - nen hal - ben Blick!

34
Geh nur hin-auf!
Sie hat
pp
mf espr.
37
gar - nichts ge - meint,
als ein Glas Was - ser ha - ben
p espr.
allmählich wieder lebhafter
40
und Ruh
vor mei - nem
fp
p

43
An - blick.
O-der spot-ten hat sie wol - len!
mf
f
46
Viel-leicht—?
Wenn sie nur spot - tet,
we - nig-stens
p
dim.
p
49
ist's doch schon ei - ne
cresc.
simile

51
Gna - de, ei - ne un - ver-dien - te,
f
55
das weiß Gott!
ff
f
r.
dim.
58
r.
mf
dim.
p

Nimmst einen Fiaker

ARABELLA

Music by
HUGO VON HOFMANNSTHAL

Music by
RICHARD STRAUSS

Prestissimo (𝅗𝅥 = 92)

MANDRYKA:

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Meno mosso ♩. = 69
15
Kel- ler! Füllst ei - nen Wa - gen an mit Ro -
espr.
dim.
p
20
sen, ei - nen mit ro - ten und wei - ßen Ka -
25
me - lien! Wal - zer soll sie auf
mf
p
31
Blu - men tan - zen, Ab - schied neh - men
espr.
pp
espr.

37
von Mäd - chen - zei - ten! Spä - ter
p
espr.
mf
42
breit' _ ich mei - ne Hän - de, sie wird nicht mehr
l.
espr.
dim.
p
47
Wal - zer tan - zen, a - ber tan -
l.
espr.
cresc.
3
f
51
- zen auf mei - nen Hän - den!
p

Lieben, Hassen, Hoffen, Zagen

ARIADNE AUF NAXOS

Music by
HUGO VON HOFMANNSTHAL

Music by
RICHARD STRAUSS

Echo's lines have been omitted.

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15
tempo primo
(stärker)
A - ber we - der Lust noch Schmer - zen, ab -
espr.
mf
19
- ge stor - ben auch der Pein, das ist töt - lich dei - nem Her - zen,
cresc.
p
dim.
23
und so musst du mir nicht sein! Musst dich aus dem
pp

26
3
Dun - kel he - ben wär es auch um neu - e Qual!
cresc.
29
Le - ben musst du, lie - bes Le - ben, le - ben noch dies
mf
dim.
33
ei - ne Mal.
poco calando
pp
dim.
pp
Ped.
Ped.
Ped.
*

Come, master

THE RAKE'S PROGRESS

Libretto by
W.H. AUDEN and CHESTER KALLMAN

Music by
IGOR STRAVINSKY

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11
Must of their plea-sures and the so - ber few are
14
bound by the in - fle - xi - ble Ought of their du - ty,
17
be - tween which sla - ve-ries there is no - thing to choose. Would
21
you be hap - py? Then learn to act free - ly. Would you act free - ly?
p
p
sf
p
stacc.

24
Then learn to ig - nore those twin ty - rants of ap - pe-tite and
stacc.
28
con - science. There - fore I coun - sel you, Mas - ter—
f – p
f p
31
rubato
a tempo
♩ = 104
poco meno mosso
Take Ba - ba the Turk to wife. Con - si - der her pic - ture once
p marc.
f p
sf
mf
34
poco rall.
♩ = 92
more, and as you do so re - flect u - pon my words.

38
♪ = 98
In youth the pan-ting
p
stacc.
43
slave pur-sues The fair e - va - sive dame; Then, caught in col-der fet - ters,
48
woos Wealth, Of - fice or a name; Till,
poco sf
stacc.
53
p sub.
old, dis - ho - noured, sick, down - cast And fai - ling in his wits,

57
In Vir-tue's nar-row cell at last The wi - thered bonds-man sits.
61
♩ = 98
ff
mf
stacc.
f
64
That man, that man a - lone, that
67
man a - lone his fate ful - fils, For he a - lone,
71
for he a - lone is free Who choo - ses what to will, and wills His choice as
cresc.

75
des - ti - ny.
ff
p
Tempo I ♩ = 98
78
(♩ = ♪)
No eye his fu-ture can fore-tell, No law his past ex-
p
poco sf
p
83
plain Whom nei-ther Pas-sion may com - pel, Nor Rea - son
sf
p
88
can res - train.
p
stacc.

I burn! I freeze!

THE RAKE'S PROGRESS

Libretto by
W.H. AUDEN and CHESTER KALLMAN

Music by
IGOR STRAVINSKY

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10
De - fea - ted, mocked, a - gain I sink In ice and flame,
13
in ice and flame to lie. But Hea - ven's will
16
I'll hate and till E - ter - ni - ty de - fy.

(looking at Tom)
19
f
Your sins, my foe, be-fore I go Give me some
ff
(with a magic gesture)
22
po - wer to pain: To rea - son blind shall be your mind; Hence-
sempre sff
(Slowly Nick sinks into the grave.)
a tempo
25
forth be you in - sane!
ff
fff

ARIAS AND ROLE EXCERPTS FOR BASS OR BASS-BARITONE

Teller's Aria

DOCTOR ATOMIC

Libretto by
PETER SELLARS
drawn from original sources

Music by
JOHN ADAMS

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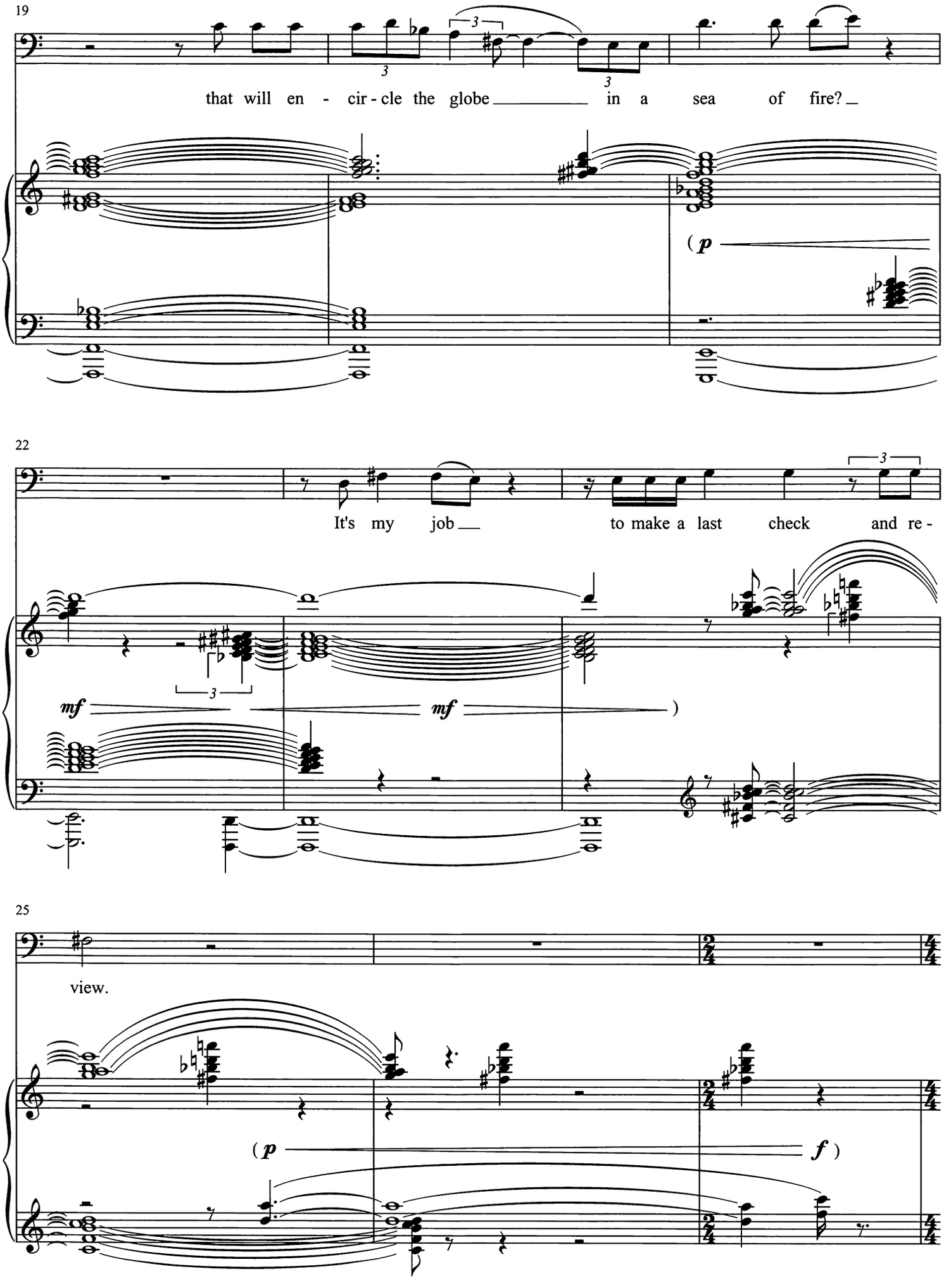
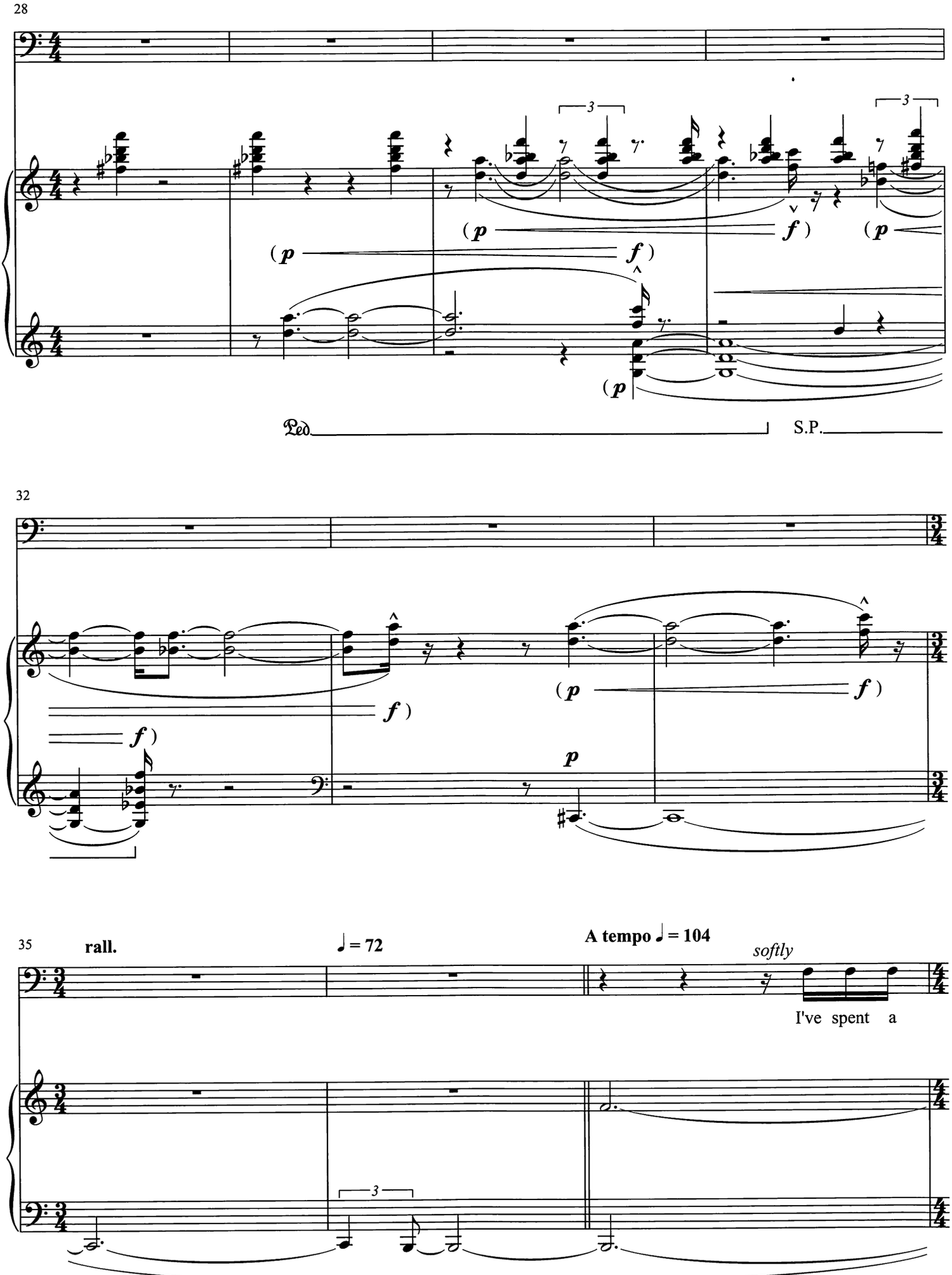
10
that we might have mis - cal - cu - la - ted, that the ex -
(p ff)
13
plo - sion could be much larg - er than we had an - ti - ci - pat - ed.
4:3
(p < ff)
16
Slower ♩ = 104
3
3
3
Might we not be set - ting off a huge chain re - ac - tion
(p
mf
)


19
that will en - cir - cle the globe in a sea of fire?
(p
22
It's my job to make a last check and re -
mf
mf)
25
view.
(p
f)


28
(p f)
(p f)
(p
Ped
S.P.
32
f)
f)
(p f)
p
35
rall.
♩= 72
A tempo ♩= 104
softly
I've spent a

38
great deal of time
in -
p
40
dulg - ing
in con - trolled
fan - ta - sies,
42
try - ing to dream up

44
new,
new, un - dis - cov - ered laws of
46
na - ture,
un - dis - cov - ered
48
laws that a sud - den re - lease of a - tom - ic
p

50
en - er - gy
might bring
in - to play.
52
There was a
pizz.
S.P.
55
pos - si - bil - i - ty
that the test
blast
might

57
touch off a na - tur - al phe - nom - e - non,
59
a na - tur - al phe - nom - e - non
61
that is not con - tra - ry to our know - ledge, but per - haps be -
mp
3
3
3
3

64
yond our ex - per - i - ence.
In Ju -
p
67
ly, three years a - go I
(p mf)
69
made some of the in - i - tial cal - cu - la - tions,
(p mf)

71
and my fig - ures in - di - ca - ted that the
(p mf p)
73
bomb would, in - deed, cre - ate e - nough
(p mf)
75
heat to ig - nite the earth's at - mo - sphere.
3

Simon's Aria

THE SHOEMAKERS' HOLIDAY

Based on the play by Thomas Dekker
Adaptation and additional lyrics by
JOHN OLON-SCRYMGEOUR

Music by
DOMINICK ARGENTO

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12
f
Bright-est can - dles burn a - pace.
mf
15
a piacere
–But it's a mad life! It's a stir-ring life! It's a fine and
f
colla voce
p
mf
18
vel - vet life! Both vir - t'ous souls and
f

21
a piacere
vi - cious doth ad - vance.
–But it's a fine life!
mf
f
colla voce
24
rall.
a tempo
mf
cresc.
It's a vel-vet life!
It's a mad and stir-ring life!
All men are mad, all
p
rall.
a tempo
mp
cresc.
29
f
mf
cresc.
mad, all mad knaves all!
All beg-gars, rogues and
ff strepitoso
decresc.
mp
cresc.
33
f
dim.
mp
rall. e dim.
thieves, –yet this mad knave looks soft on all.
Why then does not he grieve?
dim.
mp
rall. e dim.

Molto meno mosso
tratt.
a tempo
40
mp
He weeps for joy to see this world's de - cay!
tratt.
a tempo
LH
p
poco più f
44
He weeps for joy to see the sun look old!
tratt.
a tempo
mp
poco a poco cresc. ed accel.
48
mf
To see the moon mad at her of - ten change!
To see the stars on-ly by night to shine!
poco a poco cresc. ed accel.

Tempo primo
ff
54
f
Vir - tue hides her come - ly
f
mf
57
a piacere
face.
–But it's a mad life!
It's a stir-ring life!
f
colla voce
p
60
It's a fine and vel - vet life!
mf
f
63
mf
dim.
mp
Why, why, why do I see the
mf
dim.
p

68
p a piacere
foul so fair?
How oth - er - wise but I be mad,
pp
pp
falsetto
73
pp
ff
mad,
mad,
mad?
Poor Si - mon
ff
Più mosso che tempo I
79
Eyre!
molto marc.
85
sfz (p
ff
molto cresc. ed accel.
ff
sfz

There's a Law

TROUBLE IN TAHITI

Text and Music by
LEONARD BERNSTEIN

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15
SAM: mp
There's a law; There's a
18
law a - bout men: There are men who can make it, and men who can -
21
cresc.
not; There are fish who go swim-ming and
24
f
fish who wind up in the pot!
cresc.
mf

27
f
There are men Who will
f
f
p
marc.
30
stud - y the books 'til Judg-ment Day, And ex - am - ine the tech-niques of win-ners ga -
33
lore; There are men Who will prac-tice the rules re -
36
f marc.
li-gious-ly: Ev'ry day they'll im-prove just a ti - ny bit more: And they'll

39
put all their soul be - hind it; All their e - go, pow - er, drive, and
quasi f
42
will and de - sire be - hind it, And they'll throw them-selves in:
ff
f cresc.
45
But they nev - er will win, they
mp sub., legato
p sub.
48
nev - er will win, They nev - er, nev - er, nev - er, nev - er will win!
cresc.
f
cresc.
f

51
54
mp grazioso
sfzp
57
f
dim.
60
mp
There's a law:
p

63
There's a law a - bout men:
There are
66
men who are flab - by and men who are thin;
There are
69
cresc.
fish who are fat - tish and fish who are trim in the fin.
f
cresc.
mf
72
There are men
Who will
f
p
marc.

75
sweat out their days in cab - i - nets, And be pum-meled and bad-gered and beat-en and
78
rolled. There are men Who will sweat out their nights in
81
Turk-ish baths; They'll buy ev-'ry re duc-ing ma-chine that is sold. And they'll
f marc.
84
live for a week on lem - ons; And an - oth - er week on grass and
quasi f

87
ff
wa - ter and crack-ers and lem - ons, And lay off of the gin;
f cresc.
90
mp sub.
legato
But they'll nev - er be thin, they'll
p sub.
93
cresc.
f
nev - er be thin, They'll nev - er, nev - er, nev - er, nev - er be thin!
cresc.
f
96
mp grazioso
sfzp

99
f
dim.
102
(whistling)
15ma
p
106
(15)
(whistling)
110
(15)
accel.
f
mp cresc. ed accel.

Più mosso ♩. = 116

114

ff sub.

The win - ner!! The

f

117

win - ner is born a win - ner! He nev - er will have to

120

wor - ry a - bout his din - ner! He nev - er will have to

123

mp sub.

think a - bout get - ting thin - ner! 'Cause he's a

126

cresc.

win - ner, a Na - ture Boy, A he - ro, a he - ro in a

p

130

mf *cresc. sempre*

sto - ry, A sto - ry with a won - der - ful se - quel:

cresc. sempre

f *cresc.*

f

134

ff *sostenuto*

a tempo *poco accel.*

Men are cre - at - ed un - e - qual!!

f *broadly*

sfz *agitato*

137

ff *sempre* **Ancora più mosso ♩. = 126**

with increasing excitement

There are men That what - ev - er they touch will

140
turn to gold, And their ev-'ry de-ci-sion will al-ways be right. There are
143
men Who can han-dle the work of sev-en men, And still
Meno mosso ♩. = 92
holding back, with force
146
man-age to sleep sev-en hours a night. You can throw all your weight a-
149
gainst them, All your fire, snow and hail and dark-est dis-as-ter a-

152
ff sempre tenuto
gainst them: They'll re-spond with a grin;
f cresc.
155
f sempre
For they al - ways will win, they al - ways will win, they
p sub.
158
cresc.
rall.
A tempo (♩. = 92)
al - ways, al - ways, al - ways, al - ways will win!
ff
161

Claggart's Aria

O beauty, o handsomeness, goodness

BILLY BUDD

Words by
E.M. FORSTER and ERIC CROZIER

Music by
BENJAMIN BRITTEN

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11
Would that I lived in my own world al - ways,
p
13
in that de-prav - i - ty to which I was born.
15
cresc.
There I found peace of a
pp cresc.
17
sort. There I es-tab-lished an or - der such as
p
p
cresc.

20
reigns in hell.
22
f
But a - las, a - las! the light shines in the
espr.
f
24
dim.
dark - ness, and the dark - ness
dim.
p
26
com - pre-hends it and suf - fers.

28
p intensely
O beau - ty, o
pp
30
hand - some-ness, good - ness, would that I'd nev - er
32
più p
seen you! Would that I'd nev - er seen you!
più p
moving forward - - - - to - - - - - - - - - -
36
cresc.
Hav - ing seen you, what choice re-mains to me?
ppp
pp
cresc.
1
2
3

Quick and determined ♩ = 160

40

ff

None! None! I am doomed to an - ni - hi - late you, I am

ff *fp* *fp*

43

vowed to your des - truc - tion. *cantabile* I will wipe you off the

stacc. sempre *pp*

46

face of the earth! off this ti - ny float - ing

f *f* *stacc.* *pp*

49

frag - ment of earth, off this ship where for - tune has led you.

f *pp* *stacc.* *f* *f*

52
pp
First I will trou - ble your
pp stacc.
55
hap - pi - ness. I will mu - ti - late and si - lence the bo - dy where you
pp
58
dwell. It shall hang from the yard - arm, it shall fall in -
mf
p stacc.
p
61
- to the depths of the sea, and all shall be as if
f
mf
cresc.

64
noth - ing had been! No, you can - not es -
f
67
cape. With hate and en - vy I am strong - er than
8va
ff
sfp
70
love.
sfp
cresc.
73
with force
cantabile
So may it be! So may it be! O
ff
pp
fp
pp
ff
pp
Ped.
*

lively
78
beau - ty, o hand - some-ness good - ness,
espr.
mf
81
you are sure - ly in my pow - er
sf
mf
84
to - night. Noth - ing
sf
mf
87
can de-fend you! Noth-ing can de-fend you!
sf
più f
sf

gradually dying away

90

ff

Noth - ing! Noth - ing! Noth - ing!

poco a poco calando

f *ff* *f* *ff* *f* *ff* *f*

94

dim.

So may it be! So may it

p

mf *p* *p*

99

be! For what hope re - mains if

pp *ppp*

103

espress.

love can es -

106 **As before (agitated)**

pp cresc.

cape? If love still

pp *pp espr.*

108

lives and grows strong where I can - not

dim.

110

en - ter, what hope is there in my

pp *pp* *dim.*

113

senza voce (whispered)

own dark world for me? No!

pp

ppp

117
cresc.
f
I can-not be - lieve it!
No!
That were tor - ment
p
mf
sf
dim.
6
6
120
dim.
G.P.
Very slow
p sotto voce
too keen!
I, John Clag-gart,
3
pp
G.P.
ppp
124
5
Mas - ter - at-Arms up - on the In-do-mit-a-ble,
have you in my power,
pp
p
126
f
and I will des-troy you,
I will des - troy you...
mf
p
pp

Raleigh's Song

GLORIANA

Libretto by
WILLIAM PLOMER

Music by
BENJAMIN BRITTEN

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13
dost thou here?'
'Pride,' doth the o-ther an-swer,
'Brings
19
pp
you, my lord, too near.'
Slow
f
These two are ri - vals, like
pp
f
26
Quick
The blue fly and the bee:
(r.h.)
pp
31
p
'Buzz,' quoth the blue fly,
'Hum,'
quoth the bee,
sfz
pp

36
'How can this bu - sy - bo - dy Take pre -
f
40
pp
- ce - dence of me?'
pp
Slow
45
f
When head and heart are hot Then tongue and
f
ff
sf
f
dim.
49
p
hand are wild: So, Ma'am, it looks to me.
pp p
pp

Bottom's Dream

A MIDSUMMER NIGHT'S DREAM

Libretto adapted from William Shakespeare by
BENJAMIN BRITTEN and PETER PEARS

Music by
BENJAMIN BRITTEN

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14
animating
ho.
Pe-ter Quince?
Flute the bel-lows mend-er?
pp
17
Snout the tin-ker?
Starve-ling?
ff
(He hunts around)
20
Quick and agitated ♩. = 178
8va
pp
pp stacc.
24
8va
cresc.
simile
28
8va
f
dim.

32
pp
Slow (as before) ♩ = 60
37
pp
God's my life!
Sto-len hence
and left me a-sleep;
pp
p
pp express.
40
p express.
dim.
I have had a
dream,
past the
wit of man,
to
say,
what
mp
p
3
3
dim.
Very steady ♩ = 72
43
dream
it
was.
Me-thought I
was,
pp
pp
3

45

dim.

there is no man can tell what. Me-thought I was,

p *p* *cresc.*

simile

47

and me-thought I had. But man is but an ass

f

49

animating

if he can of-fer to say what me-thought I had.

mp *ff*

f

51

Very quick ♩ = ♩. = 80

p gaily

The

f *p*

54
eye of man hath not heard,
mp
8va
59
the ear of man hath not seen,
65
man's hand is not a - ble to taste,
f
8va
70
his tongue to con - ceive nor his heart to re -

75
Broadly (𝅗𝅥. = 𝅗𝅥)
port,
what my
ff
f
cresc.
79
dream was, what my dream was, my
81
animated
excited
dream.
I will get Pe - ter
p
83
Quince the car-pen-ter to write a bal-lad, a bal-lad of this dream, and it shall be
slow cresc.
8va
3
ff

85
pp (falsetto)
called_ Bot - tom's Dream, Bot - tom's Dream be -
with the voice
f ppp
f ppp
f ppp
88
Quietly
pp musing
cause it hath no bot - tom;
ppp
and I will
3
f ppp
pp
91
(going)
sing it in the lat - ter end of the play, _ be - fore the Duke. Per - ad -
pp
pp
(sustain with ped.)
93
ven-ture to make it the more gra-cious, I shall sing it at her death.
pp
8va

Hear me, O Lord

SUSANNAH

Text adapted from the play by
WILLIAM SAROYAN

Libretto and Music by
CARLISLE FLOYD

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16
sun comes.
Re-turn, O Lord, and hark-en to my plea fer fer-give-ness. Re -
p sub. e legato
19
ceive my con-fes-sion, O Lord, an' hear the words o' my re-pent-ance. It's a
mf
mp
p
21
hor-ri-ble thing I have done. Fer-give the weak-ness o' my flesh, O Lord, an' con-
mf marcato
23
demn me not to the e-ter-nal fire fer my sin a-gainst Thee an' the wom-an. She was un-
3
mf marcato
f

25
touched, O Lord! She was un - touched be-fore her young bod-y was de - filed by my hands, de -
ff largamente
28
filed by my lust. Fer - give me, O Lord, an' grant her Thy peace. O, fer -
ff con intensita
31
give me, dear Lord, an' re - turn un - to me. Thou hast gone far a - way be-yond the
cresc.
fp e legato
34
sound of my call - in'. Re - turn and grant my tor - tured soul the balm of Thy for - give-ness.
diminuendo
pp

Più mosso
37
What shall I do if Thou de-sert me?
Leave me not with this weight of sin op -
f
sempre cresc.
Allargando
40
press - in' me an' con - demn me not to the fires of hell.
Re - turn, O Lord, I pray Thee, O re -
cresc.
Molto deliberato
44
turn! And let this cup, if it be Thy will, pass from me.
fffp
mp
Tempo I (♩ = 72)
50
mp
rall.
pp

I'm a lonely man, Susannah

SUSANNAH

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CARLISLE FLOYD

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6
ward it be's_ in heav - en an' there's lit - tle re - ward here be - low. But
mp
8
e - ver now an' then I near go mad, I need a wo - man so.
cresc.
f
10
I'm a lone - ly man, Su - san - nah, an' made out o' flesh an' blood an' bone an' I
pp
12
poco rall.
need some - bo - dy I can love like oth - er folks 'cause it's a lone - some work_ I do.
mp
pp
ppp

I've known I loved you

COLD SASSY TREE

Based on the novel by Olive Ann Burns

Libretto and Music by
CARLISLE FLOYD

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8

right_ from th' start, from th' first time I set

10

eyes on you. From that first day you_____

12

come to m' store my life's jes' nev - er been th'

mf *p*

Più mosso ♩ = 84

14

mp

same. But be - in' mar - ried, I was tore a - part:

p

17
mf
part o' me, hap - py, th' rest, eat up with guilt. Well, I
mf
19
did - n't want t' clean lose m' mind, so I pushed them feel - in's so far down that I
mp
21
f
al - most fer - got they was there.
mf
f
23
p
stentando
An' that's where those feel - in's stayed 'til you
pp
col canto

25

A tempo
crescendo

come here t' live with me. But now the've come back, twice_ as strong. And it

p

Tempo Iº

27

mf

don't do no good t' tell m'self that I'm too old t' feel sech thangs 'cause m'

mf

29

heart knows th'truth o' what I feel an' don't hear a word I say. I

31

love you more than life it - self an' I jes' cain't pre - tend___ no more.

f

Poco più sostenuto ♩ = 72
33
p con fervore
What I want most now,
p caloroso
36
what m' heart is ach - in' for, what I want most in
38
mf
all th' world, is for you to be a real wife t' me,
mp
mf
41
t' be a real wife t' me.
mfp
pp

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For Baritone

John Adams

DOCTOR ATOMIC
Batter my heart

A FLOWERING TREE
Storyteller's Aria

NIXON IN CHINA
News has a kind of mystery
Mister Premier

Dominick Argento

THE ASPERN PAPERS
What a yielding nature she has

CASANOVA'S HOMECOMING
You have already heard one sermon tonight

MISS HAVISHAM'S FIRE
If in the years to come

A WATER BIRD TALK
The Lecturer (Theme)

Leonard Bernstein

MASS
A Simple Song

Benjamin Britten

ALBERT HERRING
The Vicar's Aria (Virtue, says Holy Writ)
Tickling a trout
Churchyard's agog with a crowd of folk

BILLY BUDD
Billy Budd, king of the birds!
Billy's Farewell (Look! Through the port comes the moonshine astray!)

GLORIANA
Cecil's Song of Government
Cecil's Report

A MIDSUMMER NIGHT'S DREAM
O Helen, goddess

THE RAPE OF LUCRETIA
Lucretia! I'm sick of that name!
Tarquinius's Aria (Within this frail crucible of light)

Carlisle Floyd

OF MICE AND MEN
George's Aria (You bet it's gonna be diff'rent)

WILLIE STARK
We all come out of the earth

John Gay, realized by Benjamin Britten

THE BEGGAR'S OPERA
Thus Gamesters united in friendship

Sergei Rachmaninoff

АЛЕКО (ALEKO)
Каватина Алеко (Aleko's Cavatina)

ФРАНЧЕСКА ДА РИМИНИ (FRANCESCA DA RIMINI)
Любви твоей хочу я! (Lanceotto's Aria)

Ned Rorem

OUR TOWN
When I got married

Richard Strauss

ARABELLA
Nimmst einen Fiaker
Sie gibt mir keinen Blick

ARIADNE AUF NAXOS
Lieben, Hassen, Hoffen, Zagen

Igor Stravinsky

THE RAKE'S PROGRESS
Come, master
I burn! I freeze!

For Bass-Baritone and Bass

John Adams

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Teller's Aria

Dominick Argento

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Simon's Aria

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Raleigh's Song

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Bottom's Dream

Carlisle Floyd

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I've known I loved you

SUSANNAH
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